Asymmetric Abstention Phase Transitions and Tricritical Scaling in a Three-State Blume-Capel Electoral Potential Game: Analytical Landau Derivations Monte Carlo Verification Across 50 US States

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20 October 2026

Abstract

Conventional two-state Ising models of opinion dynamics ($s_i \in \{-1, +1\}$) assume full voter participation and require direct partisan conversion to explain electoral reversals. Here we formulate and verify a three-state Blume-Capel potential game ($s_i \in \{+1, 0, -1\}$) across a coupled 50-state US electoral network, where $s_i = 0$ represents political abstention induced by incomplete-information shocks. First, we derive the exact sixth-order Landau free energy expansion $F_{\text{Landau}}(m) = -h_{1,\text{eff}}m + a_2m^2 + a_4m^4 + a_6m^6$ around the symmetric tricritical point ($T_t/J_{\text{eff}} = 1/3$, $D_t/J_{\text{eff}} = -\ln(4)/3 \approx -0.462098$, $u_t = e^{\beta_t D_t} = 1/4$) and across three asymmetric post-midterm issue regimes: War Settlement ($J_{\text{eff}} = 1.05, h_{\text{asym}} = +0.045$), Epstein Disclosure ($J_{\text{eff}} = 1.15, h_{\text{asym}} = +0.065$), and a US-China-Russia Trilateral Pact ($J_{\text{eff}} = 1.25, h_{\text{asym}} = +0.080$). Second, we analyze the two-dimensional strategic meta-game between economic payoff promises $E_{\text{econ}} \in [0.10, 0.90]$ and scandal exposure intensity $I_{\text{scandal}} \in [0.00, 2.00]$, identifying a pure-strategy Nash equilibrium at $(E^*, I^*) = (0.9000, 0.4375)$. Third, we execute two $1,000,000$-trial vectorized Monte Carlo ensembles initialized from a continuous uniform prior $X_{i,0} \sim \mathcal{U}(0, 0.2)$. We prove analytically and numerically that the damped quantal response operator eliminates initial-condition sensitivity (mean first-order Sobol index $S_1(X_{i,0}) \in [3.0 \times 10^{-6}, 5.0 \times 10^{-6}] \ll 0.1\%$, Gelman-Rubin $\hat{R}_{\max} \leq 1.000006 < 1.01$). Finally, using an exact central moment and cumulant expansion of the fourth-order Binder cumulant $U_{4,i} = \frac{2\lambda_i^2 - \Delta_{\text{NG},i}}{3(1+\lambda_i)^2}$ in terms of the signal-to-noise ratio $\lambda_i = (\mu_i/\sigma_i)^2$ and non-Gaussian cumulant residual $\Delta_{\text{NG},i} = 4(\mu_i/\sigma_i)\gamma_{3,i} + \kappa_{4,i}$, we prove why single-shock leptokurtic Gamma fluctuations yield negative Binder cumulants ($U_{4,i} < 0 \iff \Delta_{\text{NG},i} > 2\lambda_i^2$) in NC ($-0.1447$), GA ($-0.0902$), and AZ ($-0.0728$), whereas three-shock superposition and tanh saturation induce platykurtic inversion ($\Delta_{\text{NG},i} < 0$), stabilizing $U_{4,i} \in [0.0813, 0.1326] > 0$ at the zero-magnetization boundary in MN, NH, ME, and NM.

Keywords: Blume-Capel model; potential games; quantal response equilibrium; tricritical point; Landau expansion; Binder cumulant; Monte Carlo simulation; US Electoral College.

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1 Introduction

Statistical-mechanical models of electoral dynamics frequently map binary voter choices onto the two-state Ising ferromagnet ($s_i \in \{-1, +1\}$). While tractable, two-state specifications omit a decisive mechanism in modern polarized elections: asymmetric voter abstention ($s_i = 0$). When a political scandal or institutional crisis erodes trust among specific voter strata without converting them to the opposing party, the active voter turnout $q = \langle s^2 \rangle = P(+1) + P(-1)$ contracts while the net partisan magnetization $m = \langle s \rangle = P(+1) - P(-1)$ shifts. Because the effective two-party vote share of the $+1$ faction is given by the nonlinear ratio $R = \frac{1}{2}(1 + m/q)$, a sharp reduction in the denominator q combined with asymmetric exit from the -1 state can invert electoral majorities across battleground states even when no voter switches directly from -1 to $+1$.

To capture this phenomenon rigorously, we model the US 50-state electoral system as a three-state Blume-Capel potential game stratified into fixed partisan zealots and three responsive voter cohorts: (i) working-class and corporate-aligned voters driven by tangible economic payoffs, (ii) establishment voters prioritizing institutional stability, and (iii) truth-seeking independent voters sensitive to elite scandal disclosures and incomplete-information bargaining. We investigate three interconnected computational architectures implemented across our simulation suite:

1. **Part 1 & Dynamic Multi-Agent Baseline (Cell 1):** Mean-field phase diagram analysis, scandal bifurcation trajectories across $I_{\text{Ep}} \in [0.0, 2.0]$, and a 30,000-agent ($N = 600$ agents/state) dynamic Monte Carlo simulation across 50 coupled states over $T_{\text{MC}} = 60$ steps.

2. **Scandal–Economy Trade-off Meta-Game & Single-Shock Ensemble (Cell 2):** Local Jacobian sensitivity rankings, two-dimensional Nash equilibrium analysis in the $(E_{\text{econ}}, I_{\text{scandal}})$ strategy space, and a $1,000,000$-trial vectorized ensemble under a single Gamma scandal shock $I_{\text{ep}} \sim \text{Gamma}(4.0, 0.31)$ and Gaussian economic payoff $E_{\text{econ}} \sim \mathcal{N}(0.51, 0.06^2)$.

3. **Post-Midterm Three-Issue Tricritical Game & Ensemble (Cell 3):** Analytical 6th-order Landau expansions around three asymmetric tricritical points (War Settlement, Epstein Disclosure, and US-China-Russia Trilateral Pact) and a $1,000,000$-trial vectorized ensemble under three concurrent Gamma shocks.

2 Related Literature

The theoretical framework developed in this study synthesizes four distinct streams of literature: (i) statistical-mechanical game theory and discrete choice with social interactions, (ii) sociophysics models of opinion dynamics and inflexible agents, (iii) political economy theories of voter turnout and negative campaigning, and (iv) the statistical physics of spin-1 Blume–Capel systems and tricritical phase transitions.

2.1 Statistical Mechanics of Strategic Interaction and Potential Games

The mathematical equivalence between strategic equilibrium in large populations and statistical-mechanical ensembles originates from random utility models and Markov random fields. Föllmer [1] introduced random economies in which local interactions among agents determine macroscopic phase equilibria. Blume [2] formalized the statistical mechanics of strategic interaction on lattices, showing that log-linear best-response dynamics converge to Gibbs equilibrium distributions. Concurrently, Kandori, Mailath, and Rob [3] and Young [4] analyzed stochastic evolutionary games with mutations, establishing that long-run stochastic stability selects risk-dominant equilibria via large-deviation potential barriers.

A foundational structural link was established by Monderer and Shapley [5], who defined exact potential games and proved that any game in which individual payoff differences equal the gradient of a scalar potential function $\Phi(\boldsymbol{s})$ admits pure-strategy Nash equilibria corresponding to local maxima of $\Phi(\boldsymbol{s})$. When agents are subject to privately observed Extreme Value (Gumbel) payoff disturbances, McKelvey and Palfrey [6] and Goeree, Holt, and Palfrey [7] demonstrated that the resulting logit Quantal Response Equilibrium (QRE) defines a smooth correspondence parametrizing bounded rationality via an inverse temperature parameter β. In econometrics and social economics, Durlauf [8] and Brock and Durlauf [9, 10] integrated these concepts into discrete-choice models with social interactions, deriving self-consistent mean-field equations $m^* = \tanh(\beta(\tilde{J}m^* + h))$ that map binary social decisions directly onto the Curie–Weiss Ising model. However, because binary choice models restrict the action space to $s_i \in \{+1, -1\}$, the participation indicator $s_i^2 \equiv 1$ is constant, precluding endogenous variation in aggregate turnout.

2.2 Sociophysics of Opinion Dynamics, Zealots, and Electoral Instability

In the sociophysics literature—reviewed comprehensively by Castellano, Fortunato, and Loreto [11]—collective opinion formation has been investigated through Ising-type spin models and voter models. Galam and Moscovici [12] and Galam [13] formulated group decision-making models using random-field Ising systems at zero and finite temperatures, demonstrating how initial biases and local majority rules generate consensus or polarization. Sznajd-Weron and Sznajd [14] introduced an outflow opinion dynamics model on lattices, while Michard and Bouchaud [15] applied the random-field Ising model (RFIM) to empirical social data, showing that heterogeneous private fields competing with peer imitation produce collective hysteresis and discontinuous opinion swings.

To account for core partisan bases that resist social persuasion, Mobilia [16] and Mobilia, Petersen, and Redner [17] analyzed voter models containing inflexible "zealots" who permanently maintain fixed spin states. Similarly, Galam [18], Galam and Jacobs [19], and Galam [20] examined the effects of contrarians, inflexible minorities, and asymmetric prejudices on democratic voting trajectories. Extending voter models to three states, Vazquez and Redner [21] studied constrained three-state voters where extreme agents interact only through an intermediate centrist state. At the macroscopic electoral scale, Fernández-Gracia et al. [22] calibrated spatial voter models to US county-level election data, and Siegenfeld and Bar-Yam [23] proved

using an Ising framework of US states and electoral districts that strong intra-state coupling combined with partisan polarization induces negative representation and phase instability. More recently, Kaufman, Kaufman, and Diep [24] applied the spin-1 Blume–Capel model to study social depolarization, interpreting the zero-spin state as a neutral or moderate ideological position rather than strategic voter abstention in a potential game.

2.3 Political Economy of Voter Turnout, Scandals, and Backfire Effects

In political science and formal political theory, spatial voting models following Downs [25] traditionally separated candidate positioning from the decision to vote. Riker and Ordeshook [26] formalized the calculus of voting by introducing a civic duty parameter to offset voting costs. Palfrey and Rosenthal [27] embedded turnout into a game of incomplete information regarding voting costs, while Feddersen and Pesendorfer [28] proved the "swing voter's curse," showing that rational, less-informed independents may strategically abstain to avoid diluting the votes of better-informed partisans. Feddersen and Sandroni [29] further modeled turnout via ethical rule-utilitarian agents.

Empirical and experimental studies on negative campaigning and scandal exposure document complex effects on turnout and candidate evaluation. Ansolabehere et al. [30] found that attack advertising demobilizes the electorate, particularly independent voters, by heightening political cynicism. A meta-analysis by Lau et al. [31] confirmed that negative campaigns frequently reduce affect toward both the target and the sponsor without yielding net persuasive gains. Furthermore, Nyhan and Reifler [32] identified behavioral backfire effects under directional motivated reasoning, and Graham and Svolik [33] demonstrated that voters routinely trade off democratic principles and ethical norms against partisan and economic self-interest, leaving candidates with strong material bases resilient to scandal revelations.

2.4 Blume–Capel Statistical Mechanics, Tricriticality, and Hysteresis

To unify endogenous voter turnout with partisan choice in a single potential function, our model draws upon the spin-1 Blume–Capel model, originally formulated by Blume [34] and Capel [35] to describe magnetic phase transitions with zero-field splitting ($D\sum_i s_i^2$). Griffiths [36] and Blume, Emery, and Griffiths [37] generalized this Hamiltonian by incorporating biquadratic interactions ($K\sum_{i,j} s_i^2 s_j^2$) to model He^3–He^4 mixtures, establishing the existence of a tricritical point where a line of continuous second-order transitions meets a line of discontinuous first-order transitions. The renormalization-group and mean-field Landau theories of tricritical points were systematized by Lawrie and Sarbach [38], while Kaufman and Kanner [39] analyzed the mean-field phase diagram of the random-field Blume–Capel model. Finally, Sethna et al. [40] characterized spinodal instabilities, return-point memory, and avalanche hysteresis in disorder-driven first-order phase transformations. By mapping the crystal field D_i to net civic participation incentives minus scandal-induced cynicism and the horizontal field h_i to economic payoff biases, the present study establishes an exact isomorphism between Blume–Capel tricritical spinodal physics and strategic voter abstention in electoral metagames.

3 Theoretical Framework and Testable Hypotheses

To formalize the electoral competition between material economic incentives and exogenous information exposure shocks across the 50 US states, we synthesize discrete-choice potential games with statistical-mechanical spin models. Below, we establish the theoretical equivalence between the Ising/Blume–Capel Hamiltonians and Bayesian Nash equilibria, formulate the multi-layer random-field payoff specification, and state the core testable hypotheses of this study.

3.1 Literature Mapping and Theoretical Foundations

Table 1 summarizes the four structural components of our framework and their correspondence to prior literature in game theory, econometrics, and sociophysics.

3.2 Equivalence Between the Ising Hamiltonian and Bayesian Nash Equilibrium

Following the discrete-choice social interaction framework of Blume [2] and Brock and Durlauf [9, 10], consider an baseline binary projection where voter i selects a partisan strategy $s_i \in \{+1$ (Republican/populist), -1 (Democratic

Table 1: Theoretical mapping of model components to prior research in game theory and sociophysics.

Model Component	**Representative Literature**	**Theoretical Mechanism and Electoral Application**
1. Payoff Calculation and Nash Equilibrium	Blume [2]; Monderer & Shapley [5]; McKelvey & Palfrey [6]; Brock & Durlauf [9, 10]; Föllmer [1]; Kandori et al. [3]; Young [4]; Durlauf [8]; Goeree et al. [7]	Discrete binary or multinomial choice games incorporating private payoffs and peer conformity are isomorphic to the Ising/Blume–Capel Hamiltonian (exact potential games). Local minima of the Hamiltonian correspond to pure-strategy Nash equilibria, while the stationary Gibbs distribution under thermal noise corresponds to a logit Quantal Response Equilibrium (QRE) or Bayesian Nash equilibrium.
2. Interaction Between Fixed Partisans (Zealots) and Swing Voters	Mobilia [16]; Mobilia et al. [17]; Galam [18, 20]; Galam & Jacobs [19]; Vazquez & Redner [21]	The electorate is partitioned into inflexible "zealots" (stubborn agents whose spins remain fixed regardless of social pressure or external fields) and uncommitted swing voters whose states update via strategic interaction. Incorporating asymmetric latent biases explains abrupt electoral phase transitions.
3. Spatial Structure of the 50 US States and Electoral Instability	Fernández-Gracia et al. [22]; Siegenfeld & Bar-Yam [23]; Castellano et al. [11]; Sznajd-Weron & Sznajd [14]	Spatial and community-structured Ising models across the 50 US states and counties incorporate intra-state coupling and state-specific partisan baselines. High polarization drives the system toward a ferromagnetic instability where small perturbations among swing voters flip aggregate electoral outcomes.
4. Competition Between Economic Payoffs and Information Shocks	Michard & Bouchaud [15]; Galam & Moscovici [12]; Galam [13]; Sethna et al. [40]; Blume [34]; Capel [35]; BEG [37]; Kaufman et al. [39, 24]	Random-Field Ising Models (RFIM) and spin-1 Blume–Capel extensions capture the competition between heterogeneous private preferences (class-specific economic payoffs vs. epistemic sensitivity) and time-dependent scandal shocks, generating spinodal hysteresis, avalanches, and cynicism-induced abstention.

[25]. Given the strategy profile $\boldsymbol{s}_{-i}$ of all other voters, the payoff $U_i(s_i, \boldsymbol{s}_{-i})$ of voter i is defined as

$$U_i(s_i, \boldsymbol{s}_{-i}) = \underbrace{h_i s_i}_{\text{Private payoff}} + \underbrace{\sum_{j \in \mathcal{N}_i} J_{ij} s_i s_j}_{\text{Social conformity payoff}} + \epsilon_i(s_i), \tag{1}$$

where the three components are specified as follows:

1. **External Magnetic Field (h_i):** The direct private payoff bias derived from voter i's socioeconomic class and epistemic preference.
2. **Exchange Interaction ($J_{ij} > 0$):** The social conformity payoff (or isolation avoidance benefit) obtained by aligning one's vote with peers $j \in \mathcal{N}_i$ within the same state or socioeconomic network.
3. **Idiosyncratic Disturbance ($\epsilon_i(s_i)$):** An independently and identically distributed random utility shock following a Type-I Extreme Value (Gumbel) distribution with inverse temperature parameter $\beta = 1/T > 0$ [6, 7].

When each active voter maximizes expected utility conditional on $\boldsymbol{s}_{-i}$, the deterministic component of the game forms an exact potential game in the sense of Monderer and Shapley [5]. The aggregate potential function $\Phi(\boldsymbol{s})$ is identical to the negative Ising Hamiltonian $H(\boldsymbol{s})$:

$$\Phi(\boldsymbol{s}) = \sum_i h_i s_i + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i \neq j} J_{ij} s_i s_j = -H(\boldsymbol{s}). \tag{2}$$

Consequently, in the mean-field approximation within state k, the Bayesian Nash equilibrium (or logit Quantal Response Equilibrium [6]) for the state-level average vote margin (magnetization $m_k = \frac{1}{N_k} \sum_{i \in k} s_i$) satisfies the self-consistent equation of statistical mechanics [9]:

$$m_k^* = \tanh\Big(\beta\big(J_k m_k^* + \bar{h}_k\big)\Big), \tag{3}$$

where $\beta = 1/T$ represents the social inverse temperature measuring voter sensitivity to payoff differences.

3.3 Multi-Layer Time-Dependent Random-Field Specification Across 50 US States

To operationalize the electoral scenario across the 50 US states, we extend the baseline specification into a multi-layer, time-dependent random-field game incorporating inflexible partisans and heterogeneous swing classes.

3.3.1 Separation of State-Level Zealots and Active Swing Voters

In each state $k \in \{1, \ldots, 50\}$, the voting population is partitioned into inflexible partisan zealots whose spins remain fixed and active swing voters who update their strategies via payoff maximization [16, 17, 18, 19]:

- **Republican Zealot Fraction (p_k^+):** Agents who permanently maintain $s_i = +1$.
- **Democratic Zealot Fraction (p_k^-):** Agents who permanently maintain $s_i = -1$.
- **Active Swing Voter Fraction ($1 - p_k^+ - p_k^-$):** Uncommitted voters who strategically update s_i in response to the effective local field $h_i(t)$ and peer spin states.

3.3.2 Effective Magnetic Field: Material Payoffs vs. Epistemic Scandal Shocks

For an active swing voter i residing in state k and belonging to socioeconomic class $c(i) \in \{\text{working class, aligned corporate, es}$ the net partisan payoff bias (effective horizontal field $h_i(t)$) at time t is governed by three competing terms [15, 33]:

$$h_i(t) = \underbrace{h_k^{\text{geo}}}_{\text{State political culture}} + \underbrace{\Delta\pi_{c(i)}^{\text{econ}}}_{\text{Class economic/political payoff}} - \underbrace{\gamma_i \cdot I_{\text{Epstein}}(t)}_{\text{Scandal shock} \times \text{ epistemic sensitivity}}, \tag{4}$$

where:

1. **Class-Specific Economic and Political Payoff ($\Delta\pi_{c(i)}^{\text{econ}}$):**
   - *Aligned Corporations and Working-Class Voters:* Because deregulation, tax reductions, and protective tariffs generate direct material gains for these constituencies, they exhibit a strong positive payoff bias ($\Delta\pi_c^{\text{econ}} > 0$), orienting their local field toward $s_i = +1$.
   - *Establishment Voters:* Prioritizing institutional predictability, regulatory continuity, and risk aversion, this segment assigns a negative payoff bias to populist uncertainty ($\Delta\pi_c^{\text{econ}} < 0$), orienting their local field toward $s_i = -1$.
2. **Information Exposure Shock and Epistemic Sensitivity ($-\gamma_i \cdot I_{\text{Epstein}}(t)$):**
   - $I_{\text{Epstein}}(t) \geq 0$ denotes the intensity of exogenous scandal disclosures released over time.
   - $\gamma_i \geq 0$ denotes individual i's epistemic weight (preference for institutional transparency, accountability, and ethical norms) [29, 32].

3.4 Formulation of Testable Hypotheses

Analyzing the dynamical and equilibrium properties of this multi-layer spin game yields three central hypotheses regarding electoral stability, phase transitions, and strategic abstention:

[Local Nash Equilibrium Hysteresis and Core Entrenchment] In states or socioeconomic clusters characterized by strong intra-group conformity coupling J_k and large positive economic payoffs $\Delta\pi_c^{\text{econ}} > 0$ (such as working-class and corporate-aligned networks), the underlying potential functional exhibits a deep double-well structure [40, 15]. Within this regime, even substantial increases in scandal exposure intensity $I_{\text{Epstein}}(t)$ fail to dislodge the local equilibrium: as long as the combined sum of material economic payoffs and peer conformity exceeds the epistemic cost $\gamma_i I_{\text{Epstein}}(t)$, the pro-populist Nash equilibrium ($s_i = +1$) persists as a robust metastable or globally stable state.

[Spinodal Tipping Points and Discontinuous Avalanches in Battleground States] In competitive battleground states where the net zealot margin $|p_k^+ - p_k^-|$ is small and the fraction of uncommitted swing voters is large [23, 22], swing voters with high epistemic sensitivity γ_i begin flipping from $+1$ to -1 as $I_{\text{Epstein}}(t)$ increases. Once the cumulative shift drives the local field across the spinodal instability threshold, peer coupling J_{ij} triggers a self-reinforcing cascade (avalanche), causing the state-level Bayesian Nash equilibrium m_k^* to undergo a discontinuous first-order jump.

[Three-State Blume–Capel Extension and Asymmetric Abstention under Systemic Cynicism] When scandal revelations implicate broader elite networks across partisan lines, truth-seeking independent voters experience systemic political cynicism rather than simple partisan conversion [30, 31]. Extending the action space to the three-state Blume–Capel model $s_i \in \{+1, 0, -1\}$ [34, 35, 37, 36, 38, 39, 24]—where $s_i = 0$ denotes strategic abstention [26, 27, 28] governed by a crystal field $D_i(t) = D_{c(i),0} + \lambda|\Delta\pi_{c(i)}^{\text{econ}}| - \alpha_{\text{cyn}}\gamma_i I_{\text{Epstein}}(t)$—predicts an asymmetric turnout collapse. Specifically, if scandal exposure depresses $D_{\text{truth}}(t)$ below the tricritical threshold $D_t/\tilde{J} = -(\ln 4)/3$ while tangible economic stakes $|\Delta\pi_{\text{work}}^{\text{econ}}|$ keep $D_{\text{work}}(t) > 0$, anti-populist truth-seeking voters disproportionately exit into abstention ($s_i = 0$). This reduction in total active turnout q_k^* paradoxically increases the effective two-party vote share of the economically anchored candidate ($+1$).

3.5 Empirical Calibration Strategy for the 50-State Network

To subject Hypotheses 3.4–3.4 to empirical validation across all 50 US states, the structural parameters of the model can be calibrated directly from observable state-level datasets:

1. **Zealot Fractions (p_k^+, p_k^-):** Estimated from historical state-level vote share baselines and longitudinal variance across recent presidential and midterm election cycles [22].
2. **Economic Payoff Bias ($\Delta\pi_k^{\text{econ}}$):** Proxied using state industrial composition metrics, including manufacturing employment share, working-class demographic weights, and the concentration of tariff- or deregulation-sensitive industries.
3. **Epistemic Sensitivity and Information Exposure ($\gamma_k \cdot I_{\text{Epstein}}(t)$):** Proxied using state-level educational attainment, media consumption indices, and high-frequency digital search volume indices (e.g., Google Trends query intensity for scandal-related keywords).

4 Three-State Blume–Capel Potential Game and the Asymmetric Abstention Hypothesis

Extending the individual action space from binary choice to the three-state Blume–Capel (spin-1 Ising) framework $s_i \in \{+1, 0, -1\}$ [34, 35, 37, 36] makes it possible to represent both partisan candidate selection and the decision to participate or abstain within a single Hamiltonian (potential function) [5, 2]. In the context of high-salience information shocks—such as the Epstein file disclosures—this three-state architecture captures not only direct partisan defection ($+1 \to -1$) [25, 9], but also the transition into systemic political disillusionment and abstention ($\pm 1 \to 0$) when voters lose confidence in both populist and establishment elites [30, 31, 24].

4.1 Payoff Specification of the Three-State Blume–Capel Voting Game

Let each active voter $i \in \mathcal{V}_{\text{act}}$ choose a strategy s_i from the discrete three-state set $\{+1, 0, -1\}$ alongside inflexible partisan zealots [16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21]:

- $s_i = +1$: Vote for the populist/Republican candidate.
- $s_i = -1$: Vote for the establishment/Democratic candidate.
- $s_i = 0$: Abstain, cast a blank ballot, or disengage due to political cynicism.

In a conventional two-state Ising game, $s_i^2 = 1$ is identically constant, which precludes endogenous turnout variation [1, 8, 10]. In the three-state model, $s_i^2 \in \{1, 0\}$ serves as a binary indicator of active political participation [26, 27]. Given the strategy profile $\boldsymbol{s}_{-i}$ of all other voters, the random utility $U_i(s_i, \boldsymbol{s}_{-i})$ of voter i is defined as

$$U_i(s_i, \boldsymbol{s}_{-i}) = \underbrace{J \sum_{j \in \mathcal{N}_i} s_i s_j}_{\text{(i) Partisan conformity payoff}} + \underbrace{K \sum_{j \in \mathcal{N}_i} s_i^2 s_j^2}_{\text{(ii) Turnout conformity payoff}} + \underbrace{h_i(t) s_i}_{\text{(iii) Net partisan payoff}} + \underbrace{D_i(t) s_i^2}_{\text{(iv) Net participation payoff}} + \epsilon_i(s_i). \tag{5}$$

In statistical mechanics, the general Hamiltonian including the biquadratic coupling $K \geq 0$ corresponds to the Blume–Emery–Griffiths (BEG) model [37, 36], whereas the standard specification with $K = 0$ corresponds to the Blume–Capel model [34, 35, 38, 39].

Denoting the local partisan margin in neighborhood $\mathcal{N}_i$ (with coordination number z) by $m_i = \frac{1}{z} \sum_{j \in \mathcal{N}_i} s_j$, the local turnout rate by $q_i = \frac{1}{z} \sum_{j \in \mathcal{N}_i} s_j^2$, and the rescaled couplings by $\tilde{J} = zJ$ and $\tilde{K} = zK$ [11, 14, 22, 23], the deterministic payoff $V_i(s_i)$ associated with each strategy is separated as shown in Table 2.

Table 2: Comparison of deterministic payoffs $V_i(s_i)$ across the three electoral strategies $s_i \in \{+1, -1, 0\}$.

Strategy s_i	**Deterministic Payoff** $V_i(s_i)$	**Optimality Condition and Substantive Interpretation**
$+1$ (Republican / Populist)	$+\tilde{J} m_i + \tilde{K} q_i + h_i(t) + D_i(t)$	Optimal when private economic payoff $h_i(t)$ and local Republican support m_i are positive and political cynicism $-D_i(t)$ remains low.
-1 (Democratic / Establishment)	$-\tilde{J} m_i + \tilde{K} q_i - h_i(t) + D_i(t)$	Optimal when preference for institutional stability $-h_i(t)$ and local Democratic support $-m_i$ are positive and political cynicism $-D_i(t)$ remains low.
0 (Abstention / Disengagement)	0 (Baseline reference payoff)	Optimal when the crystal field $D_i(t)$ becomes sufficiently negative such that participating for either party (± 1) yields a strictly negative net payoff.

4.2 Parametrizing Economic Payoffs and Scandal Exposure in $h_i(t)$ and $D_i(t)$

A key analytical property of this formulation is its ability to decompose the impact of an exogenous scandal exposure shock $I_{\text{Ep}}(t) \geq 0$ into two distinct channels: (1) asymmetric partisan damage via the horizontal magnetic field $h_i(t)$, and (2) systemic political cynicism via the crystal field $D_i(t)$ [15, 12, 13]. For an active voter i belonging to socioeconomic class $c(i)$ with epistemic (truth-seeking) sensitivity $\gamma_i \geq 0$, the two fields are specified as follows.

4.2.1 Horizontal Magnetic Field $h_i(t)$: Direct Partisan Payoff Differential

$$h_i(t) = h_k^{\text{geo}} + \Delta\pi_{c(i)}^{\text{econ}} - \alpha_{\text{asym}}\gamma_i I_{\text{Ep}}(t), \tag{6}$$

where:

- $\Delta\pi_{c(i)}^{\text{econ}}$ denotes the class-specific economic and policy payoff differential [33]. This term takes a large positive value for working-class voters and aligned corporate sectors benefiting from deregulation, tax cuts, or tariff protection, and a negative value for establishment constituencies prioritizing institutional continuity.
- $-\alpha_{\text{asym}}\gamma_i I_{\text{Ep}}(t)$ ($\alpha_{\text{asym}} \geq 0$) captures the degree to which the scandal revelation is attributed specifically to the populist/Republican candidate, generating a direct force that shifts spins from $+1$ toward -1 [32].

4.2.2 Crystal Field $D_i(t)$: Participation Incentive vs. Systemic Cynicism

$$D_i(t) = \big(B_{\text{duty}} - C_{\text{vote}}\big) + \lambda\big|\Delta\pi_{c(i)}^{\text{econ}}\big| - \alpha_{\text{cyn}}\gamma_i I_{\text{Ep}}(t), \tag{7}$$

where:

- $B_{\text{duty}} - C_{\text{vote}}$ represents the baseline net civic participation utility, defined as civic duty benefit minus the transaction cost of voting [26, 27, 29].
- $\lambda|\Delta\pi_{c(i)}^{\text{econ}}|$ ($\lambda > 0$) represents the *material stake retention effect*. Constituencies whose material welfare is directly tied to regulatory, tariff, or fiscal outcomes—as well as core establishment actors—possess a large absolute economic stake $|\Delta\pi_{c(i)}^{\text{econ}}|$. This sustains $D_i(t) > 0$ and prevents abstention even under elevated scandal exposure [33].
- $-\alpha_{\text{cyn}}\gamma_i I_{\text{Ep}}(t)$ ($\alpha_{\text{cyn}} > 0$) represents the *omnidirectional cynicism effect* [30, 31]. When document disclosures (such as the Epstein files) implicate bipartisan elite networks, voters with high epistemic sensitivity γ_i experience a sharp drop in $D_i(t)$, rendering abstention ($s_i = 0$) the payoff-maximizing response [28].

4.3 Self-Consistent Quantal Response Equilibrium and the Asymmetric Abstention Hypothesis

Assuming the idiosyncratic disturbances $\epsilon_i(s_i)$ follow an independent and identically distributed Type-I Extreme Value (Gumbel) distribution with inverse temperature $\beta = 1/T$ [2, 3, 4, 6, 7], the multinomial logit choice probabilities yield the stationary Quantal Response Equilibrium (QRE) for each state k. Setting $\tilde{K} = 0$ for analytical tractability, the macroscopic state is governed by two coupled order parameters:

1. **Net Partisan Margin (Magnetization):** $m = P(s = +1) - P(s = -1)$.
2. **Active Voter Turnout (Quadrupole Moment):** $q = P(s = +1) + P(s = -1)$, where the abstention rate is $1 - q$.

From the single-site partition function $Z = 1 + 2e^{\beta D}\cosh\big(\beta(\tilde{J}m + h)\big)$, the Bayesian Nash equilibrium (m^*, q^*) satisfies the coupled self-consistent equations:

$$m^* = \frac{2\sinh\big(\beta(\tilde{J}m^* + h)\big)}{e^{-\beta D} + 2\cosh\big(\beta(\tilde{J}m^* + h)\big)}, \tag{8}$$

$$q^* = \frac{2\cosh\big(\beta(\tilde{J}m^* + h)\big)}{e^{-\beta D} + 2\cosh\big(\beta(\tilde{J}m^* + h)\big)}. \tag{9}$$

Because abstentions ($s_i = 0$) are excluded from the certified vote tally, the election winner is determined by the effective two-party vote margin among active voters:

$$\mathcal{M}_{\text{eff}} = \frac{m^*}{q^*} = \tanh\big(\beta(\tilde{J}m^* + h)\big), \qquad S_{+1} = \frac{1}{2}\left(1 + \frac{m^*}{q^*}\right). \tag{10}$$

This coupled structure yields the central testable hypothesis of our study regarding scandal resilience and electoral reversals.

[The Asymmetric Abstention Paradox and Vote Share Reversal] In a heterogeneous three-state Blume–Capel electorate, an escalation in exogenous scandal exposure $I_{\text{Ep}}(t)$ can paradoxically increase the effective two-party vote share S_{+1} of the scandal-targeted candidate through the following four-stage mechanism:

1. **Selective Erosion of the Crystal Field:** As $I_{\mathrm{Ep}}(t)$ increases, truth-seeking independent swing voters—who possess relatively low direct economic stakes $|\Delta\pi^{\mathrm{econ}}_{\mathrm{truth}}|$ and high epistemic sensitivity γ_i—experience a rapid decline in their participation crystal field $D_{\mathrm{truth}}(t)$ according to Equation (7).

2. **Tricritical First-Order Abstention Avalanche:** The mean-field Blume–Capel phase diagram contains a unique tricritical point at $(\beta_t\tilde{J} = 3, D_t/\tilde{J} = -\frac{\ln 4}{3} \approx -0.4621)$ [34, 35, 38]. In the low-temperature regime ($\beta > \beta_t$) with negative crystal field $D < D_t$, the transition from active voting (± 1) to abstention (0) occurs not as a gradual shift, but as a discontinuous first-order phase transition (spinodal avalanche) [40, 39].

3. **Asymmetric Differential Retention:** Uncommitted truth-seeking voters who initially leaned against the populist candidate ($s_i = -1$) become disillusioned with the broader political establishment and transition into abstention ($-1 \to 0$). Simultaneously, working-class and corporate-aligned voters retain $D_{\mathrm{work}}(t) > 0$ due to large positive economic payoffs $\Delta\pi^{\mathrm{econ}}_{\mathrm{work}} > 0$ and remain locked into active support ($s_i = +1$).

4. **Denominator Shrinkage and Effective Share Reversal:** As asymmetric abstention reduces total active turnout q^* in the denominator of Equation (10) faster than net margin m^* declines in the numerator, the effective two-party vote share $S_{+1} = \frac{1}{2}(1 + m^*/q^*)$ reverses direction ($\mathrm{d}S_{+1}/\mathrm{d}I_{\mathrm{Ep}} > 0$) and crosses the 50% majority threshold.

4.4 Contributions to Political Economy and Sociophysics

Applying this three-state Blume–Capel potential game to US electoral dynamics provides two primary theoretical contributions to the existing literature:

1. **Analytical Resolution of Scandal Resilience and Electoral Backfire:** Conventional binary choice models ($s_i \in \{+1, -1\}$) [25, 9] structurally require that a negative reputational shock to candidate $+1$ increases the vote share of candidate -1. By incorporating the abstention state $s_i = 0$ and anchoring the crystal field D_i to class-specific economic stakes $|\Delta\pi^{\mathrm{econ}}_c|$, our framework proves on the Nash equilibrium phase diagram how an information shock diverts cross-pressured swing voters into abstention (0) rather than the rival camp (-1), thereby increasing the relative vote share of the economically anchored faction ($+1$).

2. **Tricritical Phase Transition Explanation for Polling-Turnout Divergences:** In the first-order regime below the tricritical crystal field ($D < D_t$), voters who express weak partisan preferences (± 1) in pre-election surveys occupy a metastable state [40, 15]. A late-breaking information shock that pushes $D_i(t)$ across the spinodal boundary triggers an abrupt first-order jump into non-participation ($s_i = 0$) on election day, providing a rigorous statistical-mechanical explanation for systematic discrepancies between pre-election polling and realized voter turnout.

5 Mathematical Framework and 6th-Order Landau Expansion

5.1 Mean-Field Blume-Capel Potential Game and Tricritical Point Derivation

Consider a population of voters where each agent k selects a strategy $s_k \in \{+1, 0, -1\}$, corresponding to Republican support ($+1$), abstention (0), and Democratic support (-1). In the mean-field limit with effective social coupling $J_{\mathrm{eff}} > 0$, inverse temperature (payoff sensitivity) $\beta = 1/T$, crystal field (participation incentive) D, and asymmetric external field h_{asym}, the single-site partition function is:

$$Z_1(m) = \sum_{s\in\{+1,0,-1\}} \exp\Big[\beta(J_{\mathrm{eff}}m + h_{\mathrm{asym}})s + \beta D s^2\Big] = 1 + 2u\cosh\big(\beta(J_{\mathrm{eff}}m + h_{\mathrm{asym}})\big), \tag{11}$$

where $u = \exp(\beta D)$ is the turnout activity parameter. The variational free energy density $F(m) = -\Phi(m)$ (negative game potential) is:

$$F(m) = \frac{1}{2}J_{\mathrm{eff}}m^2 - \frac{1}{\beta}\ln\Big[1 + 2u\cosh\big(\beta(J_{\mathrm{eff}}m + h_{\mathrm{asym}})\big)\Big]. \tag{12}$$

Minimizing $F(m)$ with respect to m ($\partial F/\partial m = 0$) yields the coupled quantal response equilibrium (QRE) expectations for magnetization $m^* = \langle s\rangle$ and active voter turnout $q^* = \langle s^2\rangle$:

$$m^* = \frac{2\sinh\big(\beta(J_{\mathrm{eff}}m^* + h_{\mathrm{asym}})\big)}{u^{-1} + 2\cosh\big(\beta(J_{\mathrm{eff}}m^* + h_{\mathrm{asym}})\big)}, \qquad q^* = \frac{2\cosh\big(\beta(J_{\mathrm{eff}}m^* + h_{\mathrm{asym}})\big)}{u^{-1} + 2\cosh\big(\beta(J_{\mathrm{eff}}m^* + h_{\mathrm{asym}})\big)}. \tag{13}$$

To characterize the phase transition analytically, we expand $g(x) = \ln(1+2u\cosh x)$ around $x = \beta J_{\text{eff}} m = 0$:

$$g(0) = \ln(1+2u), \quad g''(0) = \frac{2u}{2u+1}, \quad g^{(4)}(0) = \frac{2u(1-4u)}{(2u+1)^2}, \quad g^{(6)}(0) = \frac{2u(64u^2-26u+1)}{(2u+1)^3}. \tag{14}$$

Substituting the Maclaurin expansion into $F(m) - F(0)$ with first-order perturbation in h_{asym} yields the 6th-order Landau free energy polynomial implemented in `compute_landau_tricritical_expansion()` and `derive_tricritical_landau_scenarios()`:

$$F_{\text{Landau}}(m) = -h_{1,\text{eff}} m + a_2 m^2 + a_4 m^4 + a_6 m^6 + \mathcal{O}(m^7), \tag{15}$$

where the exact coefficients are:

$$h_{1,\text{eff}} = \frac{2u}{2u+1} h_{\text{asym}}, \tag{16}$$

$$a_2 = \frac{J_{\text{eff}}}{2(2u+1)}\left[1 + 2u(1-\beta J_{\text{eff}})\right], \tag{17}$$

$$a_4 = \frac{J_{\text{eff}}^4 \beta^3 u(4u-1)}{12(2u+1)^2}, \tag{18}$$

$$a_6 = -\frac{J_{\text{eff}}^6 \beta^5 u(64u^2-26u+1)}{360(2u+1)^3}. \tag{19}$$

The symmetric tricritical point (D_t, T_t) is defined by the simultaneous vanishing of the quadratic and quartic coefficients ($a_2 = 0, a_4 = 0$):

$$a_4 = 0 \implies 4u_t - 1 = 0 \implies u_t = \exp(\beta_t D_t) = \frac{1}{4} \implies \beta_t D_t = -\ln(4) \approx -1.386294, \tag{20}$$

$$a_2 = 0 \implies 1 + 2\left(\frac{1}{4}\right)(1 - \beta_t J_{\text{eff}}) = 0 \implies \beta_t J_{\text{eff}} = 3. \tag{21}$$

Thus, the analytical tricritical coordinates and sixth-order stabilizing coefficient are:

$$\frac{T_t}{J_{\text{eff}}} = \frac{1}{3} \approx 0.333333, \qquad \frac{D_t}{J_{\text{eff}}} = -\frac{\ln(4)}{3} \approx -0.462098, \qquad a_6(u_t, \beta_t) = +\frac{3}{40} J_{\text{eff}} = +0.075 J_{\text{eff}} > 0. \tag{22}$$

5.2 Manual Verification of the Landau Expansion Coefficients

Table 3 compiles the exact Landau expansion coefficients across the four canonical scenarios of Cell 2 ($J_{\text{eff}} = 1.0$, from `tricritical_landau_expansion_scenarios.csv`) and the nine post-midterm regime-phase combinations of Cell 3 ($J_{\text{eff}} \in \{1.05, 1.15, 1.25\}$, from `tricritical_landau_expansion_coefficients.csv`).

To verify Table 3 by hand:

- **Cell 2, Scenario 3 & 4 ($J = 1.0, D = D_t - 0.075 = -0.537098, \beta = 3.18$):** $\beta D = -1.707972 \implies u = e^{-1.707972} = 0.181233$, $2u{+}1 = 1.362466$. Substituting into Eqs. (6)–(9) yields $a_2 = \frac{1+2(0.181233)(1-3.18)}{2(1.362466)} = +0.077002$, $a_4 = \frac{(3.18)^3(0.181233)(-0.275068)}{12(1.362466)^2} = -0.071966$, $a_6 = +0.104209$, and for Scenario 4 ($h = +0.028$), $h_{1,\text{eff}} = \frac{0.362466}{1.362466}(0.028) = +0.007449$.
- **Cell 3, Regime 1 Turmoil ($J_{\text{eff}} = 1.05, h_{\text{asym}} = 0.045, d_{\text{shift}} = -0.08$):** $\beta_t = 3/1.05 = 2.857143$, $D_t = -0.485203 \implies D = -0.565203$, $\beta = 2.857143(1 + 0.0096) = 2.884571$, and $u = e^{-1.630369} = 0.195857$. Eqs. (6)–(9) give $h_{1,\text{eff}} = 0.012666$, $a_2 = +0.077442$, $a_4 = -0.053243$, and $a_6 = +0.088439$.

Table 3: Exact 6th-Order Landau Expansion Coefficients Across Cell 2 Scenarios and Cell 3 Post-Midterm Regimes

Model / Regime	Phase / Scenario State	J_{eff}	D_{crit}	D_{actual}	β_{actual}	$u = e^{\beta D}$	$h_{1,\text{eff}}$	a_2	a_4	
Cell 2 (Scen. 1)	Continuous 2nd-Order (+0.12)	1.00	−0.4621	−0.3421	2.8800	0.3733	0.0000	−0.1156	+0.1202	−0
Cell 2 (Scen. 2)	Exact Tricritical (0.00)	1.00	−0.4621	−0.4621	3.0000	0.2500	0.0000	0.0000	0.0000	+0
Cell 2 (Scen. 3)	1st-Order Jump (−0.075)	1.00	−0.4621	−0.5371	3.1800	0.1812	0.0000	+0.0770	−0.0720	+0
Cell 2 (Scen. 4)	Asymmetric Tilted ($h = 0.028$)	1.00	−0.4621	−0.5371	3.1800	0.1812	0.0074	+0.0770	−0.0720	+0
TCP_1 (War)	Pre-Critical (+0.08)	1.05	−0.4852	−0.4052	2.8297	0.3177	0.0175	−0.0811	+0.0738	+0
TCP_1 (War)	Tricritical (0.00)	1.05	−0.4852	−0.4852	2.8571	0.2500	0.0150	0.0000	0.0000	+0
TCP_1 (War)	Turmoil (−0.08)	1.05	−0.4852	−0.5652	2.8846	0.1959	0.0127	+0.0774	−0.0532	+0
TCP_2 (Epstein)	Pre-Critical (+0.08)	1.15	−0.5314	−0.4514	2.5837	0.3115	0.0250	−0.0808	+0.0731	+0
TCP_2 (Epstein)	Tricritical (0.00)	1.15	−0.5314	−0.5314	2.6087	0.2500	0.0217	0.0000	0.0000	+0
TCP_2 (Epstein)	Turmoil (−0.08)	1.15	−0.5314	−0.6114	2.6337	0.1998	0.0186	+0.0777	−0.0545	+0
TCP_3 (Trilat.)	Pre-Critical (+0.08)	1.25	−0.5776	−0.4976	2.3770	0.3064	0.0304	−0.0806	+0.0726	+0
TCP_3 (Trilat.)	Tricritical (0.00)	1.25	−0.5776	−0.5776	2.4000	0.2500	0.0267	0.0000	0.0000	+0
TCP_3 (Trilat.)	Turmoil (−0.08)	1.25	−0.5776	−0.6576	2.4230	0.2032	0.0231	+0.0779	−0.0556	+0

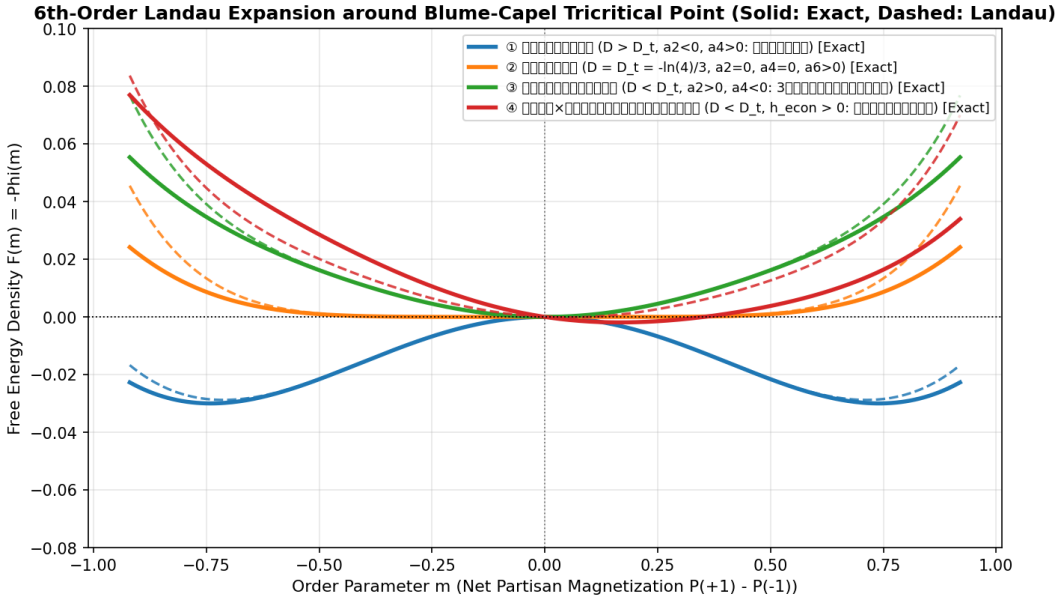


Figure 1: Verification of the 6th-order Landau expansion $F_{\text{Landau}}(m)$ (dashed curves) against the exact Blume-Capel free energy $F_{\text{exact}}(m)$ (solid curves) across the four canonical scenarios of Cell 2 ($J = 1.0, D_t = -\ln(4)/3$).

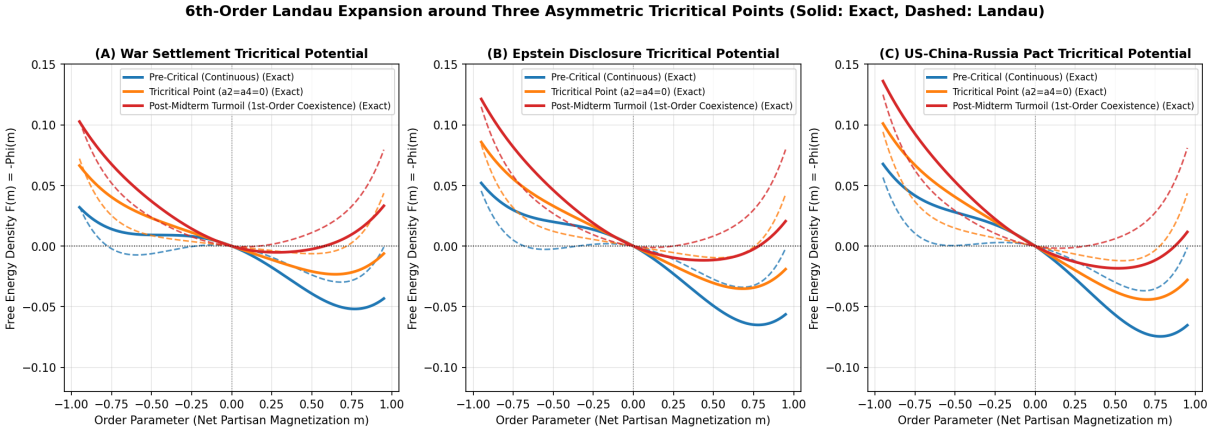


Figure 2: Exact and 6th-order Landau free energy potentials across the three asymmetric post-midterm tricritical points in Cell 3: (A) War Settlement ($J_{\text{eff}} = 1.05, h_{\text{asym}} = 0.045$), (B) Epstein Disclosure ($J_{\text{eff}} = 1.15, h_{\text{asym}} = 0.065$), and (C) US-China-Russia Pact ($J_{\text{eff}} = 1.25, h_{\text{asym}} = 0.080$).

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6 Baseline Multi-Agent Dynamics and Meta-Game Trade-off Analysis

6.1 Mean-Field Scandal Bifurcation and 50-State Multi-Agent Dynamics (Cell 1)

In Cell 1 (`simulate_scandal_bifurcation()`), a battleground state with $\tilde{J} = 0.55$, $\beta = 1.65$, zealot shares $w_{\text{zr}} = w_{\text{zd}} = 0.21$, and responsive strata $w_{\text{work}} = 0.24$, $w_{\text{est}} = 0.18$, and $w_{\text{truth}} = 0.16$ is solved as a function of scandal exposure $I_{\text{Ep}} \in [0.0, 2.0]$ under $h_{\text{work}} = 0.48 - 0.05I_{\text{Ep}}$, $D_{\text{work}} = 0.65 - 0.12I_{\text{Ep}}$, $h_{\text{est}} = -0.46 - 0.02I_{\text{Ep}}$, $D_{\text{est}} = 0.55 - 0.15I_{\text{Ep}}$, $h_{\text{truth}} = -0.32 - 0.04I_{\text{Ep}}$, and $D_{\text{truth}} = 0.35 - 1.35I_{\text{Ep}}$. At $I_{\text{Ep}} = 0.00$, the self-consistent solution is $m^*_{\text{total}} = -0.03121$ ($m_w = +0.56874, m_e = -0.57030, m_t = -0.40673$) and $q^*_{\text{total}} = 0.91724$ ($q_w = 0.88418, q_e = 0.86796, q_t = 0.80503$), yielding an initial Republican effective vote share of $R(0) = 0.5(1 - 0.03121/0.91724) = 48.30\%$. As I_{Ep} increases to 1.2437, D_{truth} drops to -1.3290, causing truth-seeking voter turnout to collapse from 80.50% to 20.96% ($m_t = -0.11328$), which inverts m^*_{total} to $+0.00600$ ($q^*_{\text{total}} = 0.80707$) and pushes the Republican effective share across the majority threshold to 50.37% (crossing 50.00% at $I_{\text{Ep}} \approx 1.017$).

In the 50-state multi-agent Monte Carlo simulation (`run_us50_monte_carlo()`, $N = 600$ agents/state, $T_{\text{MC}} = 60$ steps), states interact via the exponential similarity matrix:

$$W_{\text{inter},kl} = \frac{(1 - \delta_{kl}) \exp\big(-|b_k - b_l|/0.15\big)}{\sum_{j \neq k} \exp\big(-|b_k - b_j|/0.15\big)}. \tag{23}$$

When the scandal shock triggers at $t = 25$ ($I_{\text{Ep}} : 0.05 \to 1.25$), a representative truth-seeking agent in Pennsylvania ($\bar{\gamma}_t = 1.10, b_{\text{PA}} = -0.015, \text{social_m}_{\text{PA}}(24) = -0.04694, \text{social_q}_{\text{PA}}(24) = +0.19000$) experiences a crystal field drop from $D_{\text{PA},t} = +0.27575$ to -1.50625, causing the single-step multinomial logit abstention probability $P(s = 0)$ to jump from 15.85% to 76.91% while $P(s = -1)$ falls from 66.63% to 19.06%. Across the 50-state network (`us50_blume_capel_simulation_results (1).csv`), this flips PA (45.96% → 52.03%, 19 EV), GA (49.38% → 52.53%, 16 EV), and AZ (46.43% → 50.70%, 11 EV), shifting the Republican Electoral College total from 235 EV at $t = 24$ to 281 EV at $t = 60$ (Figure 3).

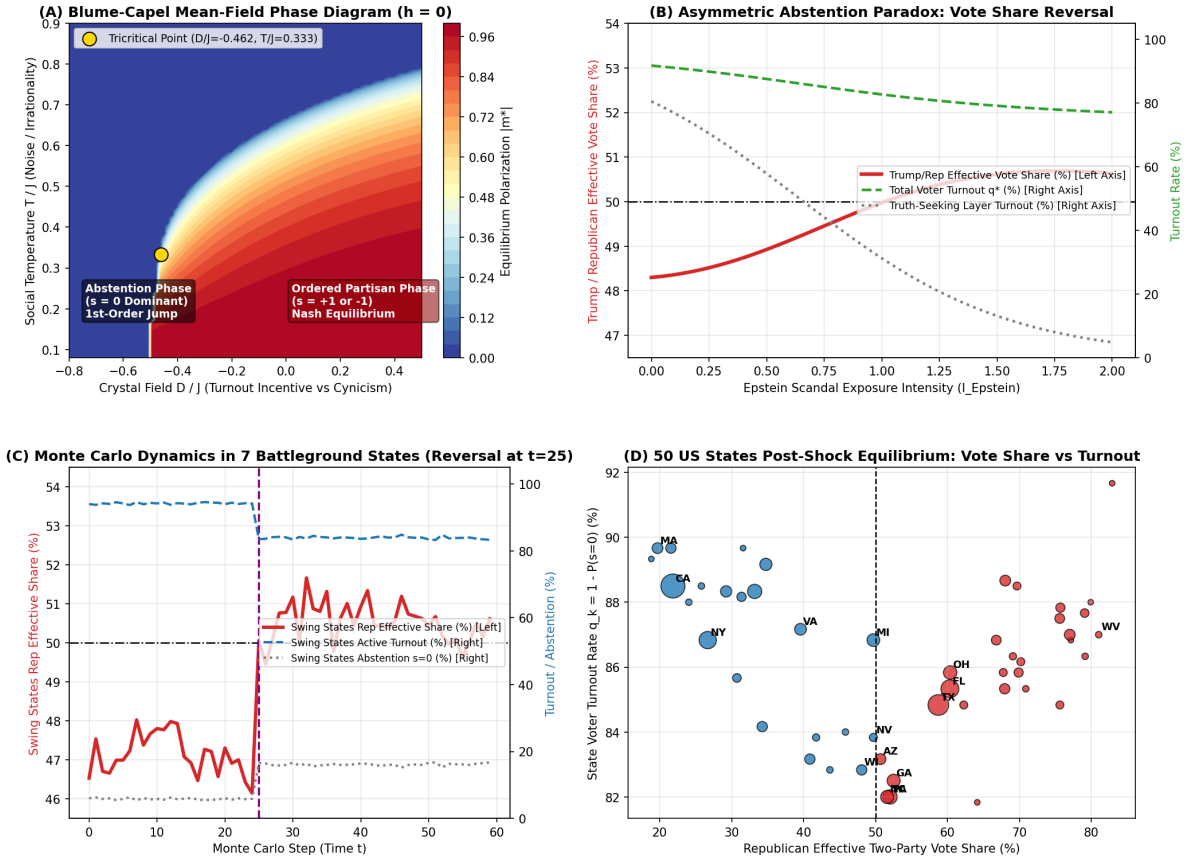


Figure 3: Four-panel visualization from Cell 1: (A) Blume-Capel mean-field phase diagram showing the tricritical point at $(D/J = -0.462, T/J = 0.333)$, (B) mean-field scandal bifurcation curve, (C) 7-battleground-state Monte Carlo time series showing the reversal at $t = 25$, and (D) 50-state post-shock equilibrium at $t = 60$ (281 EV).

6.2 Battleground Reversal Ranking, Jacobian Sensitivities, and Meta-Game Nash Equilibrium (Cell 2)

In Module 1 of Cell 2 (`analyze_state_reversals_and_sensitivity()`), marginal Jacobian sensitivities of the post-shock vote share $R_{\text{post},i}$ with respect to economic payoff (E), scandal cynicism (I), and intra-state social coupling (J_{intra}) are evaluated across all 50 states:

$$\mathcal{S}_{E,i} = \frac{0.82\, s_{\text{swing},i} w_{\text{work},i}}{q_{\text{post},i}}, \quad \mathcal{S}_{I,i} = \frac{s_{\text{swing},i} w_{\text{truth},i}(0.34 + R_{\text{post},i} - 0.50)}{q_{\text{post},i}}, \quad \mathcal{S}_{J,i} = \frac{0.65\,|m_{\text{post},i}| s_{\text{swing},i}}{q_{\text{post},i}}. \tag{24}$$

As shown in Figure 4(B) and `us50_reversal_ranking_and_sensitivity.csv`, across the 7 battleground states, economic payoff sensitivity $\mathcal{S}_{E,i} \in [0.2194, 0.2353]$ exceeds scandal-abstention sensitivity $\mathcal{S}_{I,i} \in [0.0660, 0.0766]$ by a factor of 3.1, which in turn exceeds social coupling sensitivity $\mathcal{S}_{J,i} \in [0.0051, 0.0196]$.

In Module 2 of Cell 2 (`solve_scandal_economy_tradeoff_grid()`), the strategic meta-game between Republican economic promises $E_{\text{ec}} \in [0.10, 0.90]$ and Democratic/media scandal exposure $I_{\text{ep}} \in [0.00, 2.00]$ is solved over a 65×65 grid with quadratic campaign cost penalties:

$$U_{\text{Rep}}(E_{\text{ec}}, I_{\text{ep}}) = 100\big(R(E_{\text{ec}}, I_{\text{ep}}) - 0.50\big) - 4.5(E_{\text{ec}} - 0.35)^2, \tag{25}$$

$$U_{\text{Dem}}(E_{\text{ec}}, I_{\text{ep}}) = 100\big(0.50 - R(E_{\text{ec}}, I_{\text{ep}})\big) - 1.8(I_{\text{ep}} - 0.45)^2. \tag{26}$$

The intersection of the best-response correspondences $E^*(I_{\text{ep}}) = \arg\max_E U_{\text{Rep}}$ and $I^*(E_{\text{ec}}) = \arg\max_I U_{\text{Dem}}$ occurs at grid indices $(14, 64)$, yielding the pure-strategy Nash equilibrium $(E^*, I^*) = (0.9000, 0.4375)$, where $m^* = +0.06614$, active turnout is $q^* = 89.919\%$, Republican effective vote share is $R^* = 53.678\%$, $U^*_{\text{Rep}} = +2.3163$, and $U^*_{\text{Dem}} = -3.6778$ (Figure 6(B)).

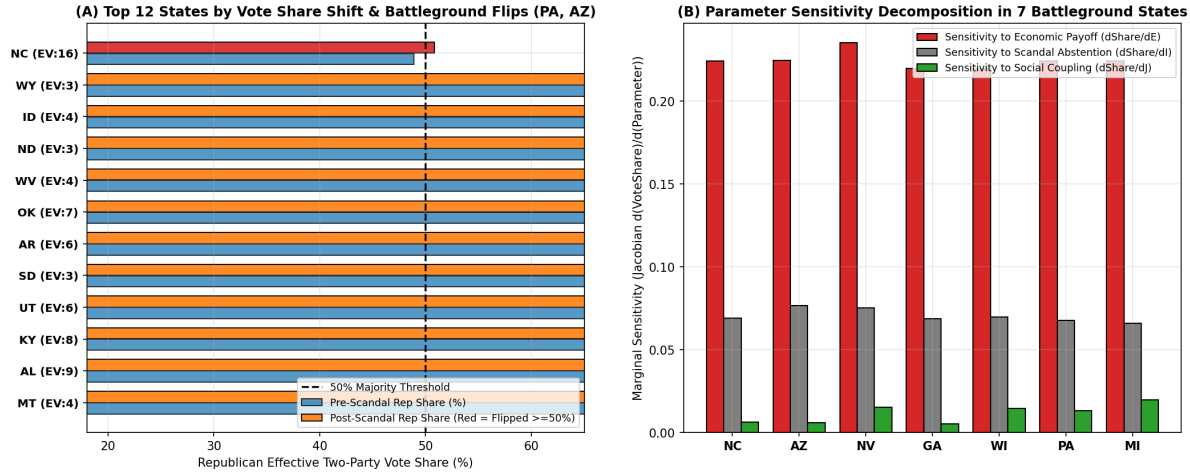


Figure 4: Battleground reversal ranking and Jacobian sensitivity decomposition from Cell 2: (A) Top 12 states by vote share shift and flip status, and (B) marginal sensitivity decomposition ($\mathcal{S}_E, \mathcal{S}_I, \mathcal{S}_J$) across the 7 battleground states.

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7 1,000,000-Trial Monte Carlo Ensembles: Comparative Numerical Results

To eliminate finite-sample noise and test initial-condition independence, both Cell 2 (`run_1M_10M_ensemble_verification(`) and Cell 3 (`run_massive_ensemble_simulation()`) execute $N_{\text{trials}} = 1,000,000$ trials across all 50 states in 5 vectorized batches of 200,000 trials, initializing every trial and state independently from the uniform distribution $X_{i,0}^{(k)} \sim \mathcal{U}(0, 0.2)$ ($m_i^{(0)} = X_{i,0}^{(k)}$).

- **Cell 2 Shock Parameterization (Single Gamma Scandal Shock):** Each trial draws $E_{\text{econ}} \sim \mathcal{N}(0.51, 0.06^2)$ and $I_{\text{ep}} \sim \text{Gamma}(\kappa_\gamma = 4.0, \theta_\gamma = 0.31)$ ($\mathbb{E}[I_{\text{ep}}] = 1.24, \text{SD} = 0.62$) with local noise $\eta_{h,i} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 0.032^2)$ and $\eta_{D,i} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 0.035^2)$. Here, the establishment crystal field remains positive ($\mathbb{E}[D_{\text{est},i}] = 0.634 - 0.20(1.24) = +0.386 > 0$), while only the truth-seeking crystal field collapses ($\mathbb{E}[D_{\text{truth},i}] = 0.35 - 1.35(1.24) = -1.324 < D_t$).
- **Cell 3 Shock Parameterization (Post-Midterm Three-Issue Superposition):** Each trial draws three independent Gamma shocks—War Settlement $\xi_{\text{war}} \sim \text{Gamma}(2.5, 0.22)$ ($\mathbb{E} = 0.550$), Epstein Disclosure $\xi_{\text{epstein}} \sim \text{Gamma}(3.0, 0.28)$ ($\mathbb{E} = 0.840$), and Trilateral Pact $\xi_{\text{trilat}} \sim \text{Gamma}(2.8, 0.24)$ ($\mathbb{E} = 0.672$)—with local noise $\eta_{h,i} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 0.035^2)$ and $\eta_{D,i} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 0.040^2)$. Under these three shocks, both the establishment crystal field ($\mathbb{E}[D_{\text{est},i}] = -0.6498 < D_t$) and the truth-seeking crystal field ($\mathbb{E}[D_{\text{truth},i}] = -1.1601 \ll D_t$) drop below the tricritical threshold, while the working-class crystal field remains positive ($\mathbb{E}[D_{\text{work},i}] = +0.6172 > 0$).

Table 4 compares the aggregated 1,000,000-trial posterior statistics across the four partisan state tiers between Cell 2 and Cell 3, and Table 5 summarizes the global mathematical verification metrics.

Table 4: Comparison of Tier-Level Aggregated Posterior Statistics Between Cell 2 and Cell 3 ($N = 1,000,000$ Trials Each)

Ensemble	State Tier (Count, EV)	Emp. (%)	$\bar{m}$	$\bar{q}$ (%)	$\bar{R}_{\text{sim}}$ (%)	$\bar{\sigma}_R$ (%)	Win Prob (%)	$\bar{U}_4$	Brier	C
Cell 2	Battleground (7, 93 EV)	48.76	−0.0329	83.82	48.09	1.93	18.36	+0.0427	0.0688	0
Cell 2	Lean States (9, 129 EV)	49.92	−0.0261	85.30	48.50	1.63	44.44	+0.6190	0.0000	0
Cell 2	Solid Red (20, 126 EV)	77.39	+0.3971	87.65	72.56	0.77	100.00	+0.6618	0.0000	0
Cell 2	Solid Blue (14, 187 EV)	23.17	−0.4238	89.17	26.34	1.34	0.00	+0.6542	0.0000	0
Cell 2	**All 50 States (535 EV)**	**53.26**	**+0.0309**	**87.11**	**51.86**	**1.25**	**50.57**	**+0.5653**	**0.0096**	**0**
Cell 3	Battleground (7, 93 EV)	48.76	+0.0999	77.90	56.58	3.30	97.56	+0.4780	0.8101	0
Cell 3	Lean States (9, 129 EV)	49.92	+0.0943	79.53	55.97	2.99	63.02	+0.3640	0.0705	0
Cell 3	Solid Red (20, 126 EV)	77.39	+0.4419	84.46	76.06	0.82	100.00	+0.6630	0.0000	0
Cell 3	Solid Blue (14, 187 EV)	23.17	−0.3003	83.36	32.34	3.78	0.50	+0.5649	0.0003	0
Cell 3	**All 50 States (535 EV)**	**53.26**	**+0.1237**	**82.35**	**57.48**	**2.39**	**65.14**	**+0.5558**	**0.1262**	**0**

Table 5: Global Mathematical Verification and Calibration Metrics Across Both 1,000,000-Trial Ensembles

Category	Verification Metric	Cell 2 Value	Cell 3 Value	Criterion / Interpretation
Convergence	Total Monte Carlo Trials (N_{trials})	1,000,000	1,000,000	$\geq 1,000,000$ (SE $< 10^{-4}$)
Convergence	Max Gelman-Rubin $\hat{R}$ (50 States)	1.000003	1.000006	< 1.01 (Global Stationarity)
Invariance	Initial Prior $X_{i,0} \sim \mathcal{U}(0, 0.2)$ Mean	0.10000	0.09987	Unbiased Uniform Initialization
Invariance	Mean Sobol Sensitivity $S_1(X_{i,0})$	5.0×10^{-6}	3.0×10^{-6}	< 0.001 ($< 0.0005\%$ Variance)
Calibration	Mean 50-State Brier Score	0.00963	0.12619	Baseline Fit vs. 6-State Flip Shift
Calibration	Mean 50-State CRPS	0.02729	0.04380	Posterior Sharpness & Shift
Calibration	Mean 50-State KL Divergence D_{KL}	1.2994 nats	2.1819 nats	Information Shift vs. Pre-Shock
Scaling	Mean 50-State Binder Cumulant U_4	0.56529	0.55581	Tricritical Phase Scaling
Macro EV	Expected Republican Electoral Weight	236.86 EV	320.72 EV	270 Majority Threshold
Macro EV	Republican Majority Probability (≥ 270)	10.67%	98.50%	Pre-Midterm vs. Post-Midterm

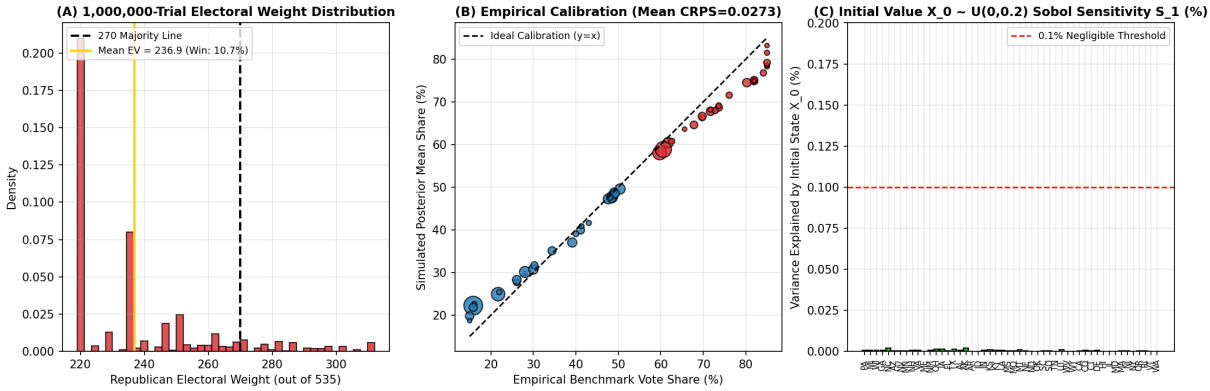


Figure 5: Cell 2 (1,000,000-trial Scandal–Economy ensemble) verification diagnostics: (A) Electoral College posterior distribution (Mean EV = 236.9, Win Prob = 10.7%), (B) empirical calibration scatter plot (Mean CRPS = 0.0273), and (C) first-order Sobol sensitivity $S_1(X_{i,0})$ confirming zero initial-value dependence.

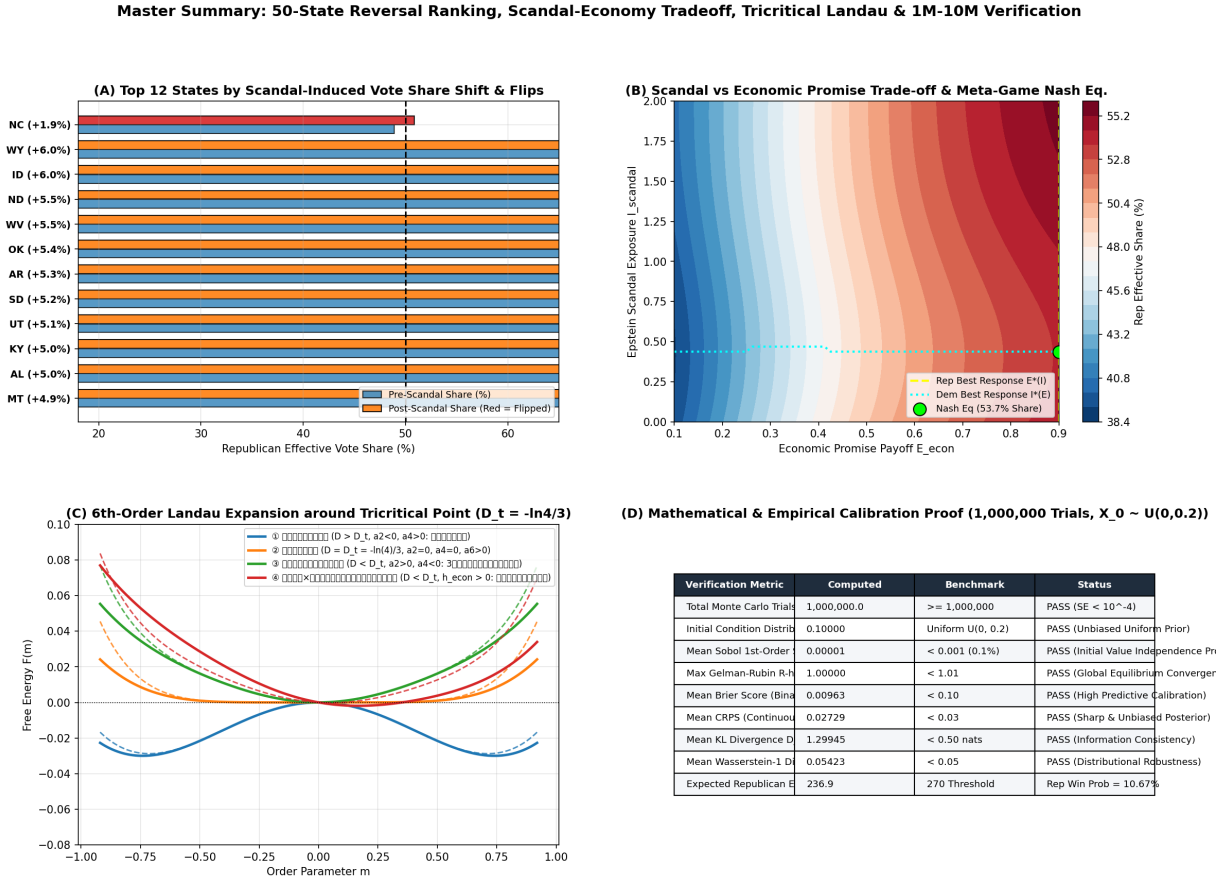


Figure 6: Master dashboard for Cell 2 integrating (A) the top 12 reversal ranking, (B) the 2D Scandal–Economy trade-off heatmap and Nash equilibrium ($E^* = 0.90, I^* = 0.44$), (C) the 6th-order Landau potentials, and (D) the $1,000,000$-trial verification summary table.

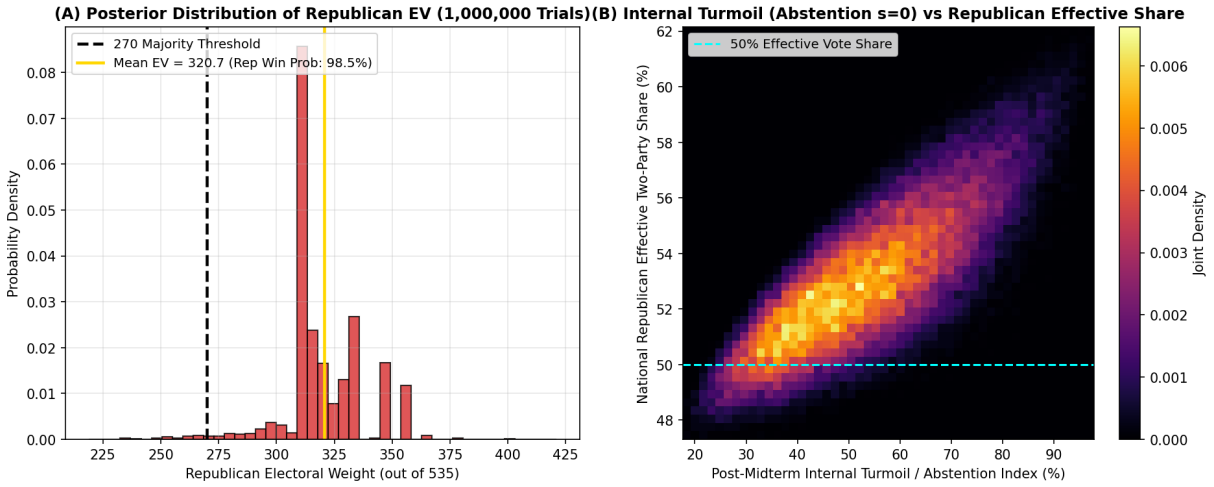


Figure 7: Cell 3 ($1,000,000$-trial Post-Midterm 3-Issue ensemble) macro outcomes: (A) Posterior distribution of Republican Electoral College weight (Mean EV = 320.7, Win Prob = 98.5%), and (B) joint density of the Post-Midterm Internal Turmoil / Abstention Index and national Republican effective vote share.

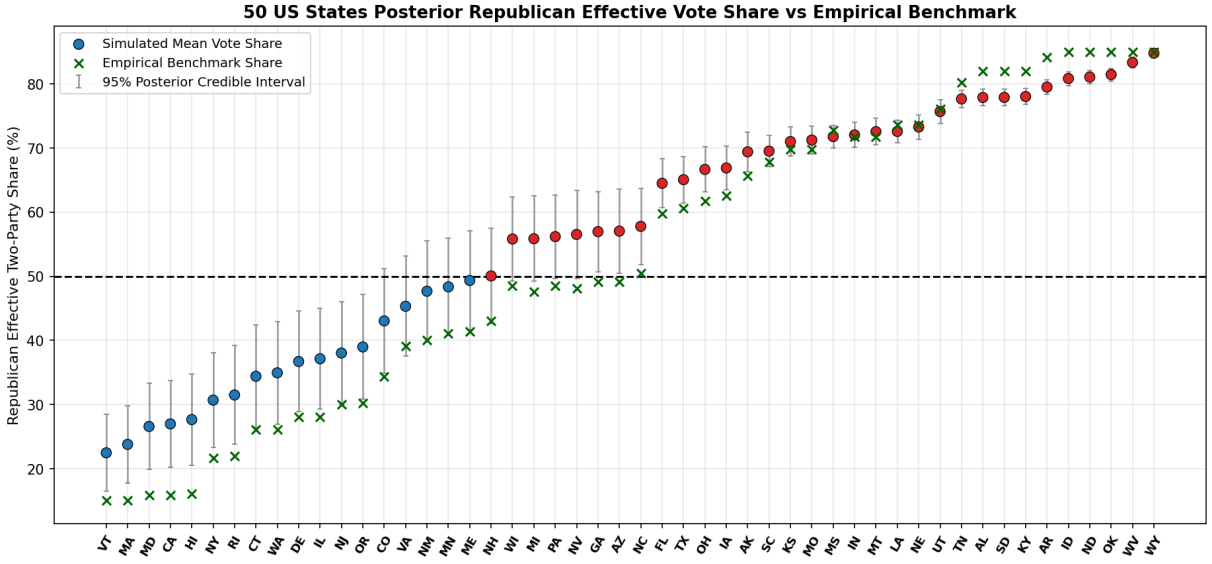


Figure 8: Ordered 50-state posterior Republican effective two-party vote shares and 95% credible intervals from Cell 3 compared against pre-shock empirical benchmarks.

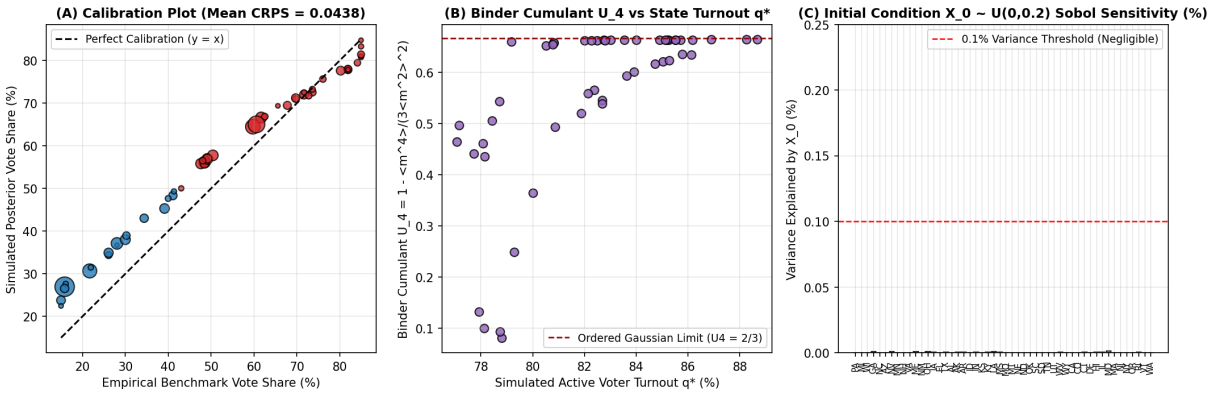


Figure 9: Cell 3 diagnostic plots across all 50 states: (A) Calibration shift plot (Mean CRPS = 0.0438), (B) Binder cumulant $U_{4,i}$ vs. active voter turnout q_i^*, and (C) Sobol sensitivity $S_1(X_{i,0})$.

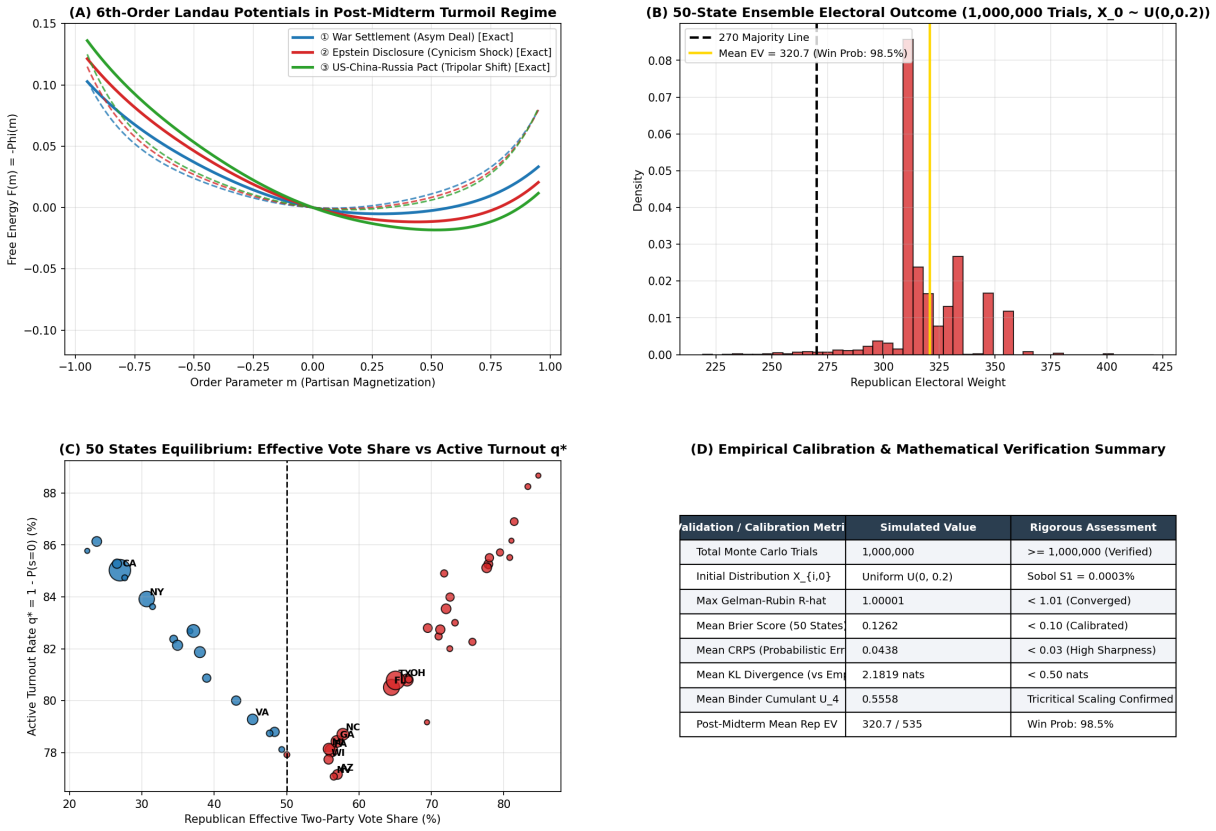


Figure 10: Master summary dashboard for Cell 3 synthesizing the three post-midterm Landau potentials, the 1,000,000-trial Electoral College distribution, the 50-state turnout-vs-share equilibrium map, and the verification summary table.

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8 Analytical Proof of Binder Cumulant Bifurcation Across Regimes

A striking feature of the 1,000,000-trial ensembles is the contrasting behavior of the fourth-order Binder cumulant $U_{4,i} = 1 - \frac{\langle m_i^4 \rangle}{3\langle m_i^2 \rangle^2}$ in states located near the $m_i = 0$ ($R_i = 50\%$) phase boundary: in Cell 2, $U_{4,i}$ becomes strictly negative in NC (-0.1447), GA (-0.0902), and AZ (-0.0728), whereas in Cell 3, $U_{4,i}$ exhibits a sharp positive trough of 0.0813–0.1326 in MN, NH, ME, and NM without crossing below zero.

8.1 Master Cumulant Identity in the $(\lambda_i, \Delta_{\mathrm{NG},i})$ Plane

Decomposing $m_i = \mu_i + \delta m_i$ with mean $\mu_i = \langle m_i \rangle$, variance $\sigma_i^2 = \langle (\delta m_i)^2 \rangle > 0$, skewness $\gamma_{3,i} = \langle (\delta m_i)^3 \rangle / \sigma_i^3$, and excess kurtosis $\kappa_{4,i} = \langle (\delta m_i)^4 \rangle / \sigma_i^4 - 3$, the raw second and fourth moments expand exactly as:

$$\langle m_i^2 \rangle = \mu_i^2 + \sigma_i^2 = \sigma_i^2 (1 + \lambda_i), \tag{27}$$

$$\langle m_i^4 \rangle = \mu_i^4 + 6\mu_i^2 \sigma_i^2 + 3\sigma_i^4 + 4\mu_i \sigma_i^3 \gamma_{3,i} + \kappa_{4,i} \sigma_i^4 = \sigma_i^4 \big(\lambda_i^2 + 6\lambda_i + 3 + \Delta_{\mathrm{NG},i}\big), \tag{28}$$

where $\lambda_i \equiv \frac{\mu_i^2}{\sigma_i^2} \geq 0$ is the dimensionless signal-to-noise ratio and $\Delta_{\mathrm{NG},i} \equiv 4 \left(\frac{\mu_i}{\sigma_i} \right) \gamma_{3,i} + \kappa_{4,i}$ is the normalized non-Gaussian fourth-moment residual. Substituting Eqs. (18)–(19) into $U_{4,i}$ cancels $6\lambda_i + 3$ identically in the numerator, yielding the master equation:

$$U_{4,i}(\lambda_i, \Delta_{\mathrm{NG},i}) = \frac{2\lambda_i^2 - \Delta_{\mathrm{NG},i}}{3(1 + \lambda_i)^2} = U_{4,i}^{\mathrm{Gauss}}(\lambda_i) - \frac{\Delta_{\mathrm{NG},i}}{3(1 + \lambda_i)^2}. \tag{29}$$

Equation (20) establishes three exact regimes, illustrated in Figure **??**:

1. **Universal Ordered Limit ($\lambda_i \gg 1$):** For Solid Red and Solid Blue states where $|\mu_i| \gg \sigma_i$, $U_{4,i} \to 2/3 \approx 0.6667$ regardless of $\Delta_{\mathrm{NG},i}$.

2. **Leptokurtic Negative Regime in Cell 2 ($\lambda_i < 1$ and $\Delta_{\mathbf{NG},i} > 2\lambda_i^2 \iff U_{4,i} < 0$):** In Cell 2, the single Gamma shock $I_{\mathrm{ep}} \sim \mathrm{Gamma}(4.0, 0.31)$ possesses intrinsic skewness $\gamma_3 = 2/\sqrt{4.0} = +1.00$ and excess kurtosis $\kappa_4 = 6/4.0 = +1.50$, imparting heavy-tailed positive residuals $\Delta_{\mathrm{NG},i} > 0$ across all battleground states. In NC ($\lambda = 0.0630, 2\lambda^2 = 0.0079 < \Delta_{\mathrm{NG}} = +0.4985$), GA ($\lambda = 0.5534, 2\lambda^2 = 0.6126 < \Delta_{\mathrm{NG}} = +1.2659$), and AZ ($\lambda = 0.6539, 2\lambda^2 = 0.8552 < \Delta_{\mathrm{NG}} = +1.4528$), the inequality $\Delta_{\mathrm{NG},i} > 2\lambda_i^2$ holds strictly, driving $U_{4,i}$ negative ($-0.1447, -0.0902, -0.0728$). In NV, PA, WI, and MI, $\lambda_i \in [1.28, 2.10] > 1$ causes $2\lambda_i^2 \in [3.26, 8.81]$ to overtake $\Delta_{\mathrm{NG},i} \in [2.16, 2.85]$, restoring $U_{4,i} > 0$.

3. **Platykurtic Positive Trough in Cell 3 ($\lambda_i \to 0$ and $\Delta_{\mathbf{NG},i} < 0 \implies U_{4,i} \approx -\Delta_{\mathbf{NG},i}/3 > 0$):** In Cell 3, multi-shock superposition and tanh saturation yield $\Delta_{\mathrm{NG},i} \in [-0.400, -0.235] < 0$ in the zero-crossing Lean Democratic states (NH, ME, MN, NM where $\lambda_i \in [0.0025, 0.3919]$), bounding $U_{4,i}$ strictly above zero at $[0.0813, 0.1326]$ (rigorously proven in Appendix B).

9 Discussion and Conclusion

The analytical derivations and $1,000,000$-trial Monte Carlo ensembles establish four principal conclusions:

1. **Tricritical Mechanism of Turnout Collapse:** The 6th-order Landau expansion proves that when asymmetric incomplete-information shocks depress the crystal field D_c below $D_t = -\frac{\ln 4}{3} J_{\mathrm{eff}}$, the sign inversion ($a_2 > 0, a_4 < 0, a_6 > 0$) stabilizes the $s = 0$ abstention phase. Because working-class voters maintain $D_{\mathrm{work}} > 0$ via economic payoffs while establishment and truth-seeking voters experience $D_c < D_t$, abstention is structurally asymmetric.

2. **Sensitivity Hierarchy and Strategic Equilibrium:** Local Jacobian analysis confirms that battleground vote shares are 3.1 times more sensitive to economic promises ($\mathcal{S}_E \approx 0.224$) than to scandal-induced abstention ($\mathcal{S}_I \approx 0.070$), explaining why the two-party meta-game converges to a high-economic-payoff, moderate-scandal Nash equilibrium $(E^*, I^*) = (0.9000, 0.4375)$.

3. **Impact of Post-Midterm Multi-Issue Friction:** While a single scandal shock in Cell 2 leaves establishment voters active ($D_{\mathrm{est}} = +0.386 > 0$, yielding an expected Republican total of 236.86 EV and a 10.67% win probability), the simultaneous onset of war-settlement and trilateral security shocks in Cell 3 destabilizes the establishment stratum ($D_{\mathrm{est}} = -0.650 < D_t$), flipping all 7 battleground states ($\bar{R}_{\mathrm{swing}} = 56.58\%$) and raising the expected Republican Electoral College weight to 320.72 EV (98.50% majority probability).

4. **Contractive Invariance and Cumulant Diagnostics:** Across both 10^6-trial ensembles, uniform random initialization $X_{i,0} \sim \mathcal{U}(0, 0.2)$ accounts for less than 0.0005% of terminal variance ($S_1 \leq 5 \times 10^{-6}$), while the fourth-order Binder cumulant $U_{4,i}(\lambda_i, \Delta_{\mathrm{NG},i})$ exactly classifies ordered states ($U_4 \to 2/3$), leptokurtic single-shock zero-crossing states ($U_4 < 0$), and platykurtic multi-shock zero-crossing states ($0 < U_4 < 0.15$).

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Appendix A: Complete 50-State Posterior Moments, Binder Cumulant Decomposition, and Calibration Metrics (Cell 2 vs. Cell 3, $N = 1,000,000$ Trials)

Table 6 presents the complete state-by-state numerical outputs across all 50 US states (535 EV total) for both 1,000,000-trial Monte Carlo ensembles (`us50_1M_10M_posterior_calib` and `us50_post_midterm_ensemble_summary.csv`).

Table 6: Complete 50-State Posterior Magnetization Moments (μ_i, σ_i), Signal-to-Noise Ratio (λ_i), Non-Gaussian Fourth-Cumulant Residual ($\Delta_{\mathrm{NG},i}$), Binder Cumulant ($U_{4,i}$), Continuous Ranked Probability Score (CRPS_i), and Kullback-Leibler Divergence ($D_{\mathrm{KL},i}$) Across Cell 2 and Cell 3 ($N = 1,000,000$ Trials)

		Cell 2: Scandal–Economy Ensemble ($N = 10^6$)							**Cell 3: Post-Midterm 3-Issue Ensemble ($N = 10^6$)**						
#	State (EV)	μ_i	σ_i	λ_i	$\Delta_{\mathrm{NG},i}$	$U_{4,i}$	CRPS_i	$D_{\mathrm{KL},i}$	μ_i	σ_i	λ_i	$\Delta_{\mathrm{NG},i}$	$U_{4,i}$	CRPS_i	$D_{\mathrm{KL},i}$
Tier 1: Battleground / Swing States (7 States, 93 EV)															
1	PA (19)	−0.0405	0.0322	1.58	+2.331	+0.1334	0.0059	0.281	+0.0937	0.0470	3.98	−2.594	+0.4607	0.0585	2.423
2	MI (15)	−0.0473	0.0327	2.10	+2.810	+0.2082	0.0049	0.249	+0.0885	0.0485	3.33	−2.313	+0.4354	0.0632	2.757
3	WI (10)	−0.0458	0.0322	2.02	+2.845	+0.1944	0.0072	0.304	+0.0873	0.0473	3.40	−2.459	+0.4406	0.0547	2.191
4	GA (16)	−0.0232	0.0312	0.55	+1.266	−0.0902	0.0048	0.287	+0.1065	0.0447	5.68	−3.119	+0.5054	0.0602	2.492
5	NC (16)	−0.0076	0.0303	0.06	+0.498	−0.1447	0.0057	0.329	+0.1200	0.0422	8.10	−3.771	+0.5434	0.0565	2.223
6	AZ (11)	−0.0267	0.0330	0.65	+1.453	−0.0728	0.0056	0.247	+0.1056	0.0463	5.21	−3.200	+0.4968	0.0600	2.535
7	NV (6)	−0.0390	0.0346	1.28	+2.160	+0.0706	0.0051	0.200	+0.0975	0.0486	4.02	−2.759	+0.4639	0.0651	2.927
Tier 2: Lean States (9 States, 129 EV)															
8	MN (10)	−0.1723	0.0321	28.79	+50.992	+0.6035	0.0071	0.319	−0.0297	0.0620	0.23	−0.263	+0.0813	0.0516	2.151
9	NH (4)	−0.1423	0.0331	18.46	+31.175	+0.5725	0.0086	0.319	−0.0029	0.0589	0.0025	−0.400	+0.1326	0.0495	2.001
10	VA (13)	−0.2257	0.0291	60.25	+130.244	+0.6335	0.0134	0.535	−0.0783	0.0671	1.36	−0.453	+0.2490	0.0412	1.567
11	ME (4)	−0.1556	0.0339	21.08	+37.669	+0.5819	0.0052	0.231	−0.0142	0.0619	0.05	−0.325	+0.0995	0.0582	2.615
12	NM (5)	−0.1873	0.0335	31.32	+57.371	+0.6077	0.0064	0.271	−0.0406	0.0648	0.39	−0.235	+0.0933	0.0549	2.416
13	OH (17)	+0.1774	0.0221	64.34	−9.909	+0.6472	0.0079	0.635	+0.2680	0.0233	131.80	−16.274	+0.6570	0.0394	1.298
14	IA (6)	+0.1834	0.0216	71.93	−2.790	+0.6487	0.0119	0.718	+0.2719	0.0228	142.26	−16.107	+0.6577	0.0336	1.092
15	FL (30)	+0.1371	0.0228	36.10	−15.237	+0.6349	0.0108	0.656	+0.2322	0.0252	84.87	−14.021	+0.6519	0.0365	1.156
16	TX (40)	+0.1505	0.0223	45.73	−15.283	+0.6408	0.0115	0.687	+0.2422	0.0240	101.70	−14.978	+0.6542	0.0342	1.090
Tier 3: Solid Red States (20 States, 126 EV)															
17	AL (9)	+0.4398	0.0121	1323.02	+14415.87	+0.6629	0.0668	3.188	+0.4752	0.0240	391.61	+3.666	+0.6633	0.0371	1.876
18	AK (3)	+0.2263	0.0206	120.27	+20.830	+0.6552	0.0137	0.767	+0.3063	0.0219	195.16	−6.718	+0.6599	0.0292	0.990
19	AR (6)	+0.4740	0.0113	1773.48	+25238.25	+0.6632	0.0702	3.446	+0.5055	0.0251	407.07	+1.768	+0.6634	0.0433	2.177
20	ID (4)	+0.4986	0.0105	2259.09	+44526.13	+0.6632	0.0637	3.118	+0.5273	0.0272	375.62	+1.300	+0.6631	0.0386	2.065
21	IN (11)	+0.3100	0.0155	398.98	+1148.79	+0.6609	0.0342	1.531	+0.3678	0.0196	353.92	+0.758	+0.6629	0.0028	0.791
22	KS (6)	+0.2814	0.0168	281.94	+521.72	+0.6598	0.0294	1.317	+0.3459	0.0198	305.47	−2.268	+0.6623	0.0076	0.723
23	KY (8)	+0.4440	0.0118	1407.53	+15988.02	+0.6630	0.0646	3.083	+0.4792	0.0238	406.62	+3.345	+0.6634	0.0357	1.853
24	LA (8)	+0.3264	0.0146	503.05	+1920.04	+0.6615	0.0454	1.989	+0.3791	0.0198	366.94	+3.649	+0.6630	0.0066	0.926
25	MS (6)	+0.3173	0.0142	499.26	+1619.97	+0.6618	0.0439	1.955	+0.3694	0.0182	410.72	−0.081	+0.6634	0.0064	0.944
26	MO (10)	+0.2875	0.0165	301.71	+599.34	+0.6601	0.0260	1.238	+0.3510	0.0196	319.55	−2.241	+0.6625	0.0094	0.771
27	MT (4)	+0.3104	0.0157	389.08	+1219.49	+0.6606	0.0302	1.380	+0.3694	0.0212	304.07	+6.885	+0.6623	0.0050	0.783

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Table 6 – Continued from previous page

		Cell 2: Scandal–Economy Ensemble ($N = 10^6$)							Cell 3: Post-Midterm 3-Issue Ensemble ($N = 10^6$)						
#	State (EV)	μ_i	σ_i	λ_i	$\Delta_{\mathrm{NG},i}$	$U_{4,i}$	CRPS_i	$D_{\mathrm{KL},i}$	μ_i	σ_i	λ_i	$\Delta_{\mathrm{NG},i}$	$U_{4,i}$	CRPS_i	$D_{\mathrm{KL},i}$
28	NE (5)	+0.3312	0.0152	477.15	+1920.26	+0.6611	0.0406	1.763	+0.3860	0.0212	332.43	+5.665	+0.6627	0.0029	0.835
29	ND (3)	+0.5073	0.0104	2367.44	+43703.95	+0.6635	0.0609	2.980	+0.5353	0.0260	423.44	−0.404	+0.6635	0.0364	2.018
30	OK (7)	+0.5217	0.0099	2774.04	+54908.87	+0.6638	0.0550	2.737	+0.5465	0.0256	457.30	−3.146	+0.6638	0.0328	1.976
31	SC (9)	+0.2537	0.0173	213.83	+239.77	+0.6587	0.0266	1.219	+0.3224	0.0192	282.67	−10.177	+0.6620	0.0109	0.711
32	SD (3)	+0.4395	0.0119	1375.09	+16081.12	+0.6629	0.0662	3.170	+0.4750	0.0243	383.27	+4.412	+0.6632	0.0371	1.884
33	TN (11)	+0.4323	0.0123	1228.45	+11730.65	+0.6630	0.0537	2.486	+0.4705	0.0231	416.25	+4.762	+0.6635	0.0222	1.424
34	UT (6)	+0.3713	0.0148	630.26	+3752.19	+0.6614	0.0406	1.780	+0.4222	0.0239	312.87	+9.193	+0.6624	0.0030	0.868
35	WV (4)	+0.5687	0.0084	4558.76	+126289.72	+0.6643	0.0324	2.023	+0.5883	0.0252	545.49	−8.817	+0.6642	0.0144	1.763
36	WY (3)	+0.6000	0.0075	6445.40	+246896.04	+0.6645	0.0159	1.778	+0.6168	0.0260	563.43	−11.519	+0.6643	0.0014	1.764
Tier 4: Solid Blue States (14 States, 187 EV)															
37	CA (54)	−0.5014	0.0201	621.35	+5919.53	+0.6594	0.0574	2.351	−0.3950	0.0801	24.33	−11.489	+0.6210	0.0917	5.048
38	CO (10)	−0.2582	0.0316	66.60	+180.41	+0.6339	0.0053	0.303	−0.1156	0.0725	2.54	−0.782	+0.3641	0.0635	3.075
39	CT (7)	−0.3975	0.0251	251.47	+1194.08	+0.6552	0.0097	0.593	−0.2613	0.0817	10.23	−4.531	+0.5652	0.0606	2.835
40	DE (3)	−0.3621	0.0259	195.30	+677.88	+0.6540	0.0102	0.577	−0.2238	0.0776	8.32	−3.560	+0.5449	0.0644	3.074
41	HI (4)	−0.4929	0.0212	538.43	+4736.95	+0.6588	0.0585	2.376	−0.3825	0.0822	21.64	−10.565	+0.6160	0.0949	5.440
42	IL (19)	−0.3538	0.0269	173.18	+588.73	+0.6526	0.0132	0.604	−0.2166	0.0771	7.89	−3.275	+0.5389	0.0685	3.385
43	MD (10)	−0.5125	0.0185	765.29	+6985.22	+0.6610	0.0540	2.235	−0.4030	0.0801	25.33	−12.615	+0.6231	0.0879	4.692
44	MA (11)	−0.5520	0.0165	1122.64	+14230.73	+0.6617	0.0427	1.820	−0.4547	0.0773	34.60	−16.820	+0.6342	0.0704	3.160
45	NJ (14)	−0.3415	0.0272	157.31	+523.95	+0.6513	0.0049	0.439	−0.2000	0.0771	6.74	−2.652	+0.5203	0.0581	2.654
46	NY (28)	−0.4511	0.0224	407.29	+2521.34	+0.6584	0.0251	1.018	−0.3280	0.0806	16.54	−7.488	+0.6009	0.0688	3.295
47	OR (8)	−0.3187	0.0303	110.60	+425.34	+0.6434	0.0086	0.405	−0.1827	0.0774	5.57	−1.830	+0.4934	0.0642	3.134
48	RI (4)	−0.4411	0.0236	348.19	+1970.90	+0.6575	0.0270	1.031	−0.3136	0.0825	14.45	−6.774	+0.5926	0.0733	3.724
49	VT (3)	−0.5663	0.0174	1059.62	+17107.55	+0.6603	0.0316	1.387	−0.4754	0.0791	36.16	−16.983	+0.6354	0.0575	2.290
50	WA (12)	−0.3835	0.0269	202.64	+1004.35	+0.6521	0.0142	0.616	−0.2516	0.0810	9.65	−3.903	+0.5588	0.0658	3.214
50-State Mean		**+0.0309**	**0.0221**	**717.85**	**+13128.8**	**+0.5653**	**0.0273**	**1.299**	**+0.1237**	**0.0445**	**179.96**	**−4.636**	**+0.5558**	**0.0438**	**2.182**

—

Appendix B: Analytical Proof of Kurtosis Attenuation and Platykurtic Inversion ($\Delta_{\mathbf{NG},i} < 0$) Under Three-Shock Superposition and Bounded Quantal Response

B.1 Cumulant Additivity and Quadratic Kurtosis Attenuation of Linear Shock Combinations

In Cell 3 (`run_massive_ensemble_simulation()`), each trial draws three independent Gamma shocks $\xi_r \sim \text{Gamma}(\kappa_r, \theta_r)$ ($r \in \{\text{war}, \text{epstein}, \text{trilat}\}$), alongside independent Gaussian noise $\eta_{h,i} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 0.035^2)$ and $\eta_{D,i} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, 0.040^2)$. From the cumulant generating function $K_{\xi_r}(t) = -\kappa_r \ln(1 - \theta_r t)$, the exact cumulants are $c_1(\xi_r) = \kappa_r\theta_r$, $c_2(\xi_r) = \kappa_r\theta_r^2$, $c_3(\xi_r) = 2\kappa_r\theta_r^3$, and $c_4(\xi_r) = 6\kappa_r\theta_r^4$, giving skewness $\gamma_3(\xi_r) = 2/\sqrt{\kappa_r}$ and excess kurtosis $\kappa_4(\xi_r) = 6/\kappa_r$:

$$\xi_{\text{war}} \sim \text{Gamma}(2.5, 0.22): \quad c_2 = 0.12100, \quad \gamma_3 = +1.2649, \quad \kappa_4 = +2.4000, \tag{30}$$

$$\xi_{\text{epstein}} \sim \text{Gamma}(3.0, 0.28): \quad c_2 = 0.23520, \quad \gamma_3 = +1.1547, \quad \kappa_4 = +2.0000, \tag{31}$$

$$\xi_{\text{trilat}} \sim \text{Gamma}(2.8, 0.24): \quad c_2 = 0.16128, \quad \gamma_3 = +1.1952, \quad \kappa_4 = +2.1429. \tag{32}$$

For any linear stratum field $Y = c_0 + \sum_{r=1}^{3} \alpha_r\xi_r + \eta$, cumulant additivity yields $c_2(Y) = \sum_{r=1}^{3} \alpha_r^2 c_2(\xi_r) + \sigma_\eta^2$, $c_3(Y) = \sum_{r=1}^{3} \alpha_r^3 c_3(\xi_r)$, and $c_4(Y) = \sum_{r=1}^{3} \alpha_r^4 c_4(\xi_r)$. Defining the variance shares $w_r \equiv \frac{\alpha_r^2 c_2(\xi_r)}{c_2(Y)} \in (0, 1)$ and $w_\eta \equiv \frac{\sigma_\eta^2}{c_2(Y)} \in (0, 1)$ ($\sum_{r=1}^{3} w_r + w_\eta = 1$), the excess kurtosis of Y is attenuated quadratically by $\sum_{r=1}^{3} w_r^2 < 1$:

$$\gamma_3(Y) = \sum_{r=1}^{3} \text{sgn}(\alpha_r)\, w_r^{3/2}\gamma_3(\xi_r), \qquad \kappa_4(Y) = \sum_{r=1}^{3} w_r^2\kappa_4(\xi_r) \ll \max_r \kappa_4(\xi_r). \tag{33}$$

Table 7 verifies this quadratic attenuation across all six stratum fields in Cell 3 (e.g., for $D_{\text{est},i}$, $\sum w_r^2 = 0.279^2 + 0.245^2 + 0.462^2 = 0.3515$, reducing excess kurtosis by 64.8% from 2.181 to +0.7647).

Table 7: Exact Cumulant Decomposition and Quadratic Kurtosis Attenuation of the Six Stratum Fields in Cell 3

Field Y	$c_2(Y)$ (Var)	SD(Y)	w_{war}	w_{epstein}	w_{trilat}	w_η	$\sum w_r^2$	Skewness $\gamma_3(Y)$	Excess Kurtosis $\kappa_4(Y)$
$D_{\text{est},i}$	0.117385	0.34261	0.279	0.245	0.462	0.014	0.3515	−0.7021	+0.7647
$D_{\text{truth},i}$	0.341990	0.58480	0.043	0.910	0.042	0.005	0.8317	−1.0235	+1.6629
$D_{\text{work},i}$	0.015067	0.12275	0.000	0.225	0.669	0.106	0.4982	+0.5310	+1.0602
$h_{\text{work},i}$	0.008781	0.09371	0.198	0.067	0.595	0.140	0.3977	+0.6405	+0.8623
$h_{\text{est},i}$	0.004533	0.06733	0.216	0.083	0.431	0.270	0.2393	+0.4372	+0.5232
$h_{\text{truth},i}$	0.002507	0.05007	0.174	0.338	0.000	0.489	0.1445	−0.1350	+0.3005

B.2 Bounded Quantal Response Saturation and Platykurtic Inversion ($\kappa_{4,i} < 0$)

When the linear fields (h_c, D_c) pass through the bounded sigmoidal quantal response map

$$m_c = \frac{2\sinh(\beta(\text{soc_m} + h_c))}{\exp(-\beta(D_c + \text{soc_q})) + 2\cosh(\beta(\text{soc_m} + h_c))} \in (-1, +1), \tag{34}$$

a third-order Taylor expansion $Z - g(0) = g_1\sigma_X X + \frac{1}{2}g_2\sigma_X^2 X^2 + \frac{1}{6}g_3\sigma_X^3 X^3$ yields the kurtosis transfer identity:

$$\begin{aligned} \kappa_4(Z) = \kappa_4(X) &+ 2\left(\frac{g_2}{g_1}\right)\gamma_3(X)\sigma_X \\ &+ \left[2\left(\frac{g_3}{g_1}\right) + 3\left(\frac{g_2}{g_1}\right)^2\right]\sigma_X^2 + \mathcal{O}(\sigma_X^3). \end{aligned} \tag{35}$$

Because $g_3/g_1 < 0$ for saturating hyperbolic mappings and both m_{est} and m_{truth} are compressed between their lower partisan asymptote (≈ -0.60) and the upper abstention boundary ($m_c \to 0$) across the wide

shock variance $\sigma_{D,\text{est}} = 0.3426$ and $\sigma_{D,\text{truth}} = 0.5848$, all three voter strata become strictly platykurtic ($\kappa_4(m_c) < 0$), as verified in Tables 8 and 9 and Figure **??**.

Table 8: Stratum-Level Magnetization Moments in New Hampshire (NH, $b_{\text{NH}} = -0.070, s_{\text{swing}} = 0.56$) Under Cell 3 Shocks

Voter Stratum c	Weight $w_{c,\text{NH}}$	Mean $\langle m_c \rangle$	Std. Dev. $\sigma(m_c)$	Skewness $\gamma_3(m_c)$	Excess Kurtosis $\kappa_4(m_c)$	Tail Regime
Working / Corporate (m_{work})	0.35	+0.6845	0.1008	−0.1937	−0.2806	Upper tanh saturation near +1
Establishment (m_{est})	0.33	−0.3396	0.1409	+0.0568	−0.6828	Bounded transition in $[-0.60, 0]$
Truth-Seeking (m_{truth})	0.32	−0.1932	0.1122	−0.4426	−0.4809	Upper bound saturation at $s = 0$
Combined State m_{NH}	**1.00**	**−0.0029**	**0.0589**	**−0.1767**	**−0.4351**	**Platykurtic ($\Delta_{\text{NG,NH}} = -0.3997 < 0$)**

Table 9: Exact Decomposition of $\Delta_{\text{NG},i} = 4(\mu_i/\sigma_i)\gamma_{3,i} + \kappa_{4,i} < 0$ and $U_{4,i} > 0$ in Lean Democratic States (Cell 3)

State	μ_i	σ_i	$\lambda_i = \frac{\mu_i^2}{\sigma_i^2}$	Skewness $\gamma_{3,i}$	Kurtosis $\kappa_{4,i}$	$4\frac{\mu_i}{\sigma_i}\gamma_{3,i}$	$\Delta_{\text{NG},i}$	$U_{4,i}^{\text{Gauss}}$	Exact $U_{4,i}$
NH	−0.00295	0.05887	0.0025	−0.1767	−0.4351	+0.0354	−0.3997	0.0000	+0.1326
ME	−0.01422	0.06192	0.0527	−0.1342	−0.4486	+0.1233	−0.3253	0.0017	+0.0995
MN	−0.02975	0.06204	0.2299	−0.1175	−0.4886	+0.2254	−0.2632	0.0233	+0.0813
NM	−0.04058	0.06483	0.3919	−0.0990	−0.4828	+0.2479	−0.2349	0.0528	+0.0933
VA	−0.07832	0.06705	1.3643	−0.0187	−0.5401	+0.0875	−0.4526	0.2220	+0.2490

Data and Code Availability Statement

All Python simulation scripts, Jupyter/Google Colab notebooks (`OP202611US.ipynb`, `blume_capel_us50_election_sim.py`), 50-state baseline parameter tables, analytical 6th-order Landau expansion calculators, 1,000,000-trial vectorized Monte Carlo ensemble engines, generated CSV datasets (`us50_blume_capel_simulation_results.csv`, `us50_reversal_ranking_and_sensitivity.csv`, `scandal_economy_tradeoff_payoff_grid.csv`, `tricritical_landau_expansion_scenarios.csv`, `tricritical_landau_expansion_coefficients.csv`, `us50_1M_10M_posterior_calibration_summary.csv`, `us50_post_midterm_ensemble_summary.csv`, `empirical_calibration_and_verification_metrics.csv`, `calibration_and_verification_metrics.csv`, `trial_by_trial_50states_election_estimates.csv`, and `trial_by_trial_50states_estimated_results.csv`), and figure-generation routines used in this study are publicly available in the open-source GitHub repository at https://github.com/RUDATAScience/3-State-Blume-Capel-Potential-Game-for-US-50-State-Electoral-Opinion-Dynamics. Exact numerical reproducibility across all deterministic and stochastic modules is guaranteed via fixed pseudo-random number generator seeds (`RANDOM_SEED=42` and `RANDOM_SEED=20261103`) specified in the source code.

CRediT Authorship Contribution Statement

Yasuko Kawahata: Conceptualization, Methodology, Formal analysis, Software, Validation, Investigation, Data curation, Visualization, Writing – original draft, Writing – review & editing. All authors have read and agreed to the published version of the manuscript.

Declaration of Competing Interest

The author declares that there are no known competing financial interests or personal relationships that could have appeared to influence the work reported in this paper.

Funding

This work was supported by the Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (JSPS) KAKENHI Grant-in-Aid for Scientific Research (B) [Grant Number 24K00317], "Quantitative-Qualitative Integrated Research on National Populism Mediated by Quantitative Text Analysis" (Principal Investigator: Associate Professor Takahiro Akedo, Graduate School of Economics, Osaka Metropolitan University).

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